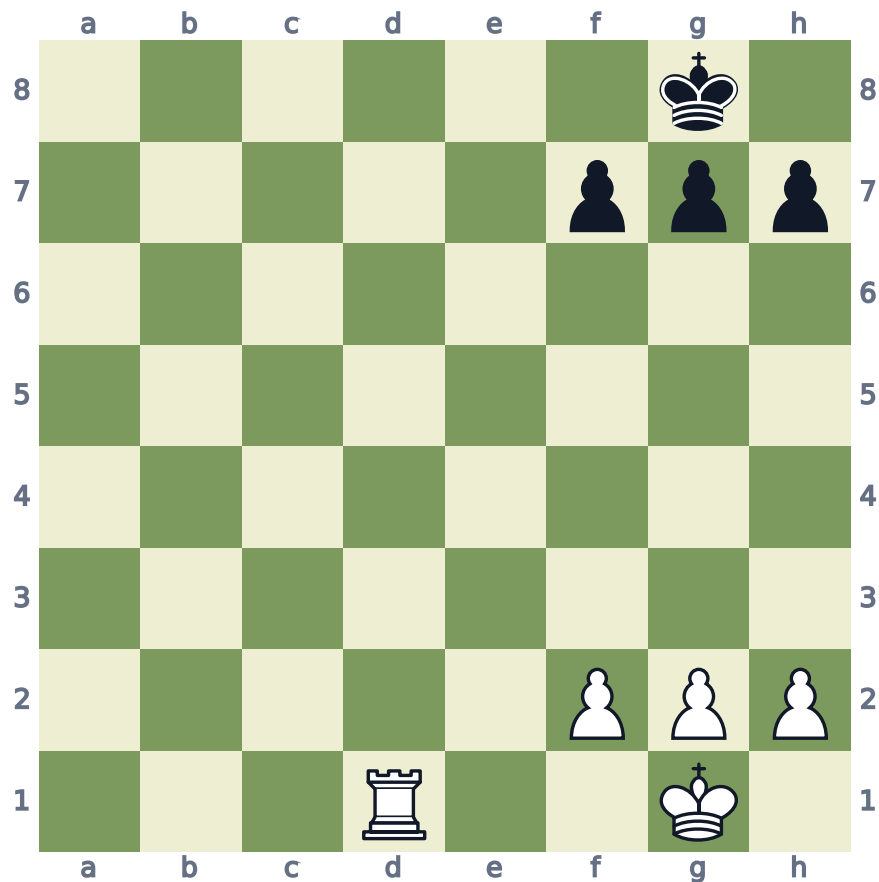


Defensive Tactics Workbook

Saving moves, counterchecks, exchanges, and active resistance



Learn to find defensive resources when the position looks frightening: remove the threat, trade the attacker, create flight, return material, counterattack, or force a draw.

24 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Learn to find defensive resources when the position looks frightening: remove the threat, trade the attacker, create flight, return material, counterattack, or force a draw.

TRAINING RULES

- Name the threat exactly; 'I am being attacked' is not a usable diagnosis.
- Search active resources before accepting a passive position.
- If several moves survive, choose the one that leaves the attacker with the fewest future forcing options.
- A move that loses material may be best if it trades queens, ends mate, or builds a fortress.
-

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 24 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

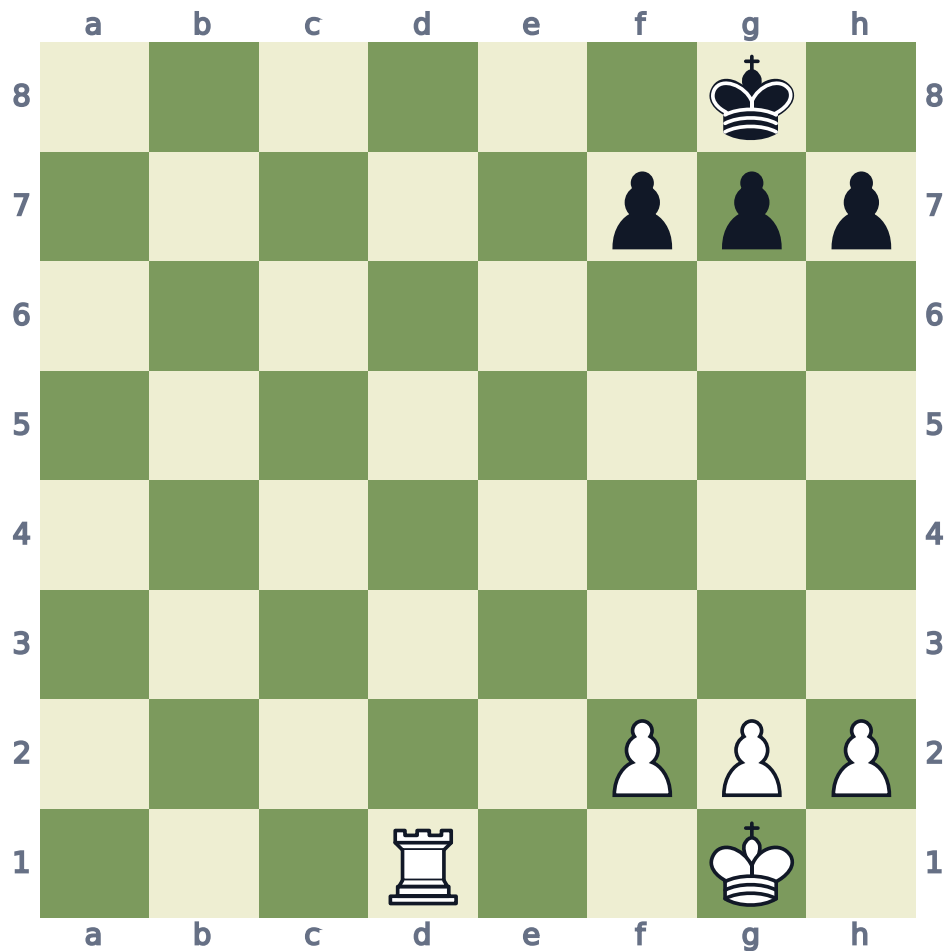
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 24

Stop Back-rank mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

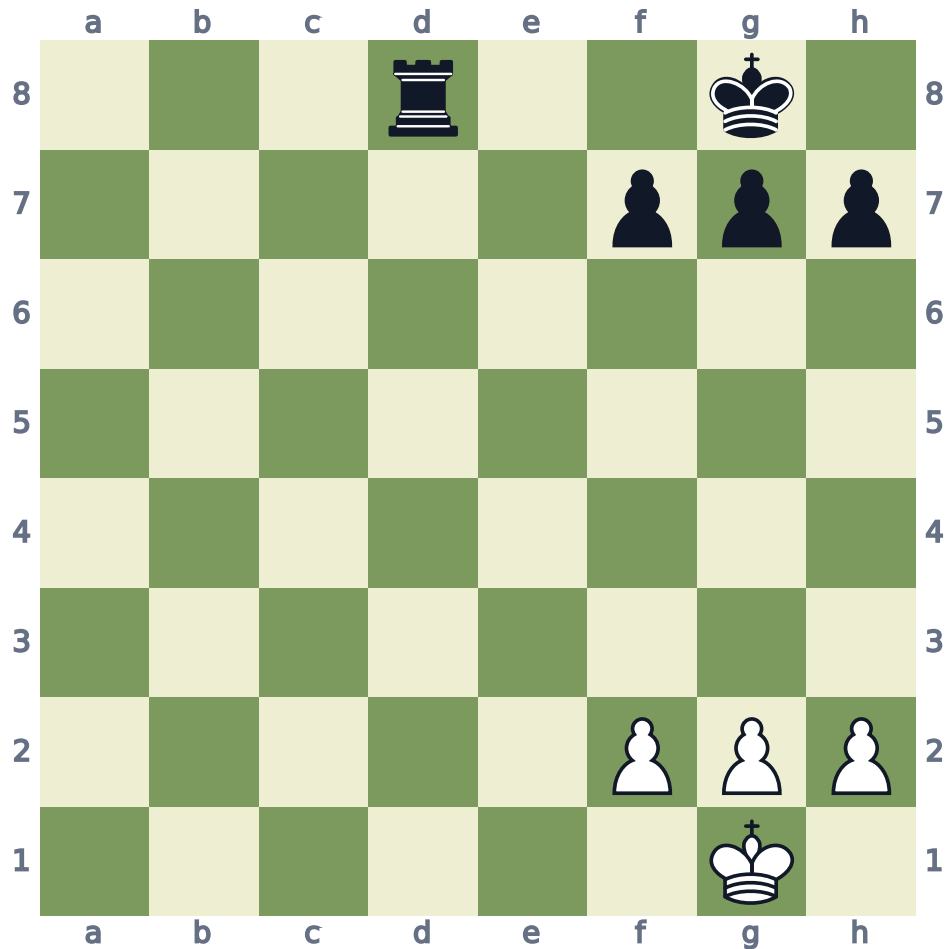
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 24

Stop Back-rank mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

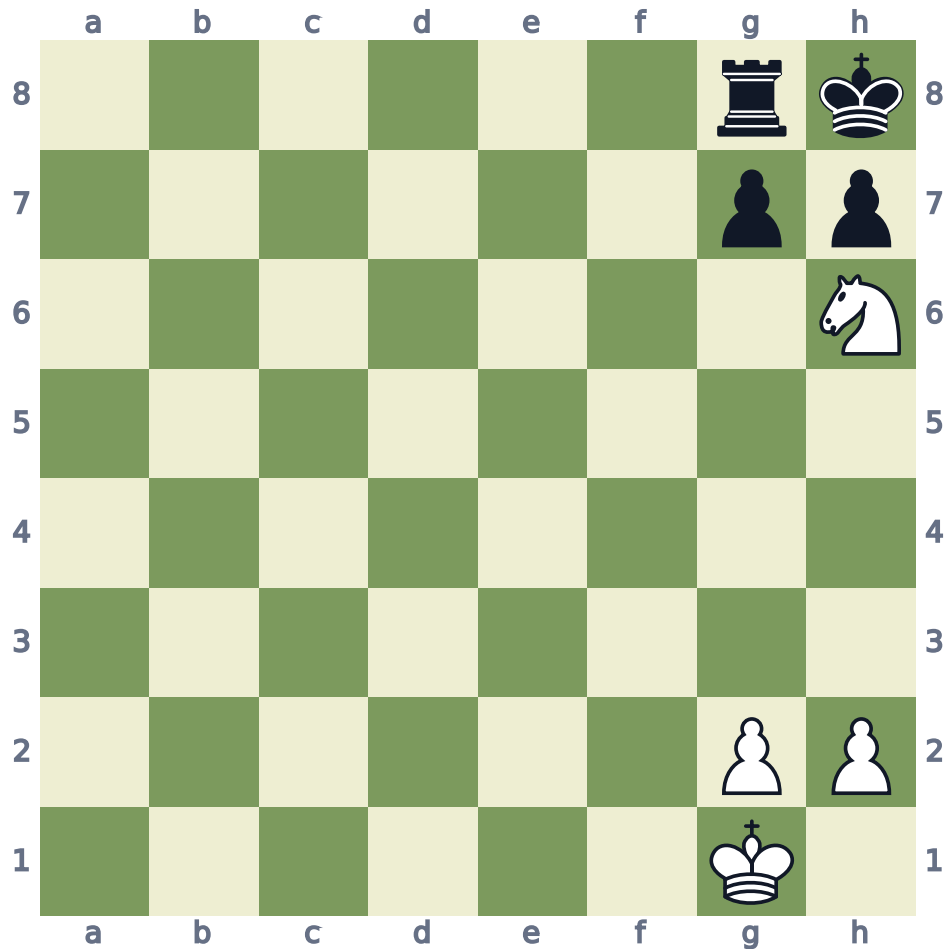
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 24

Stop Smothered mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

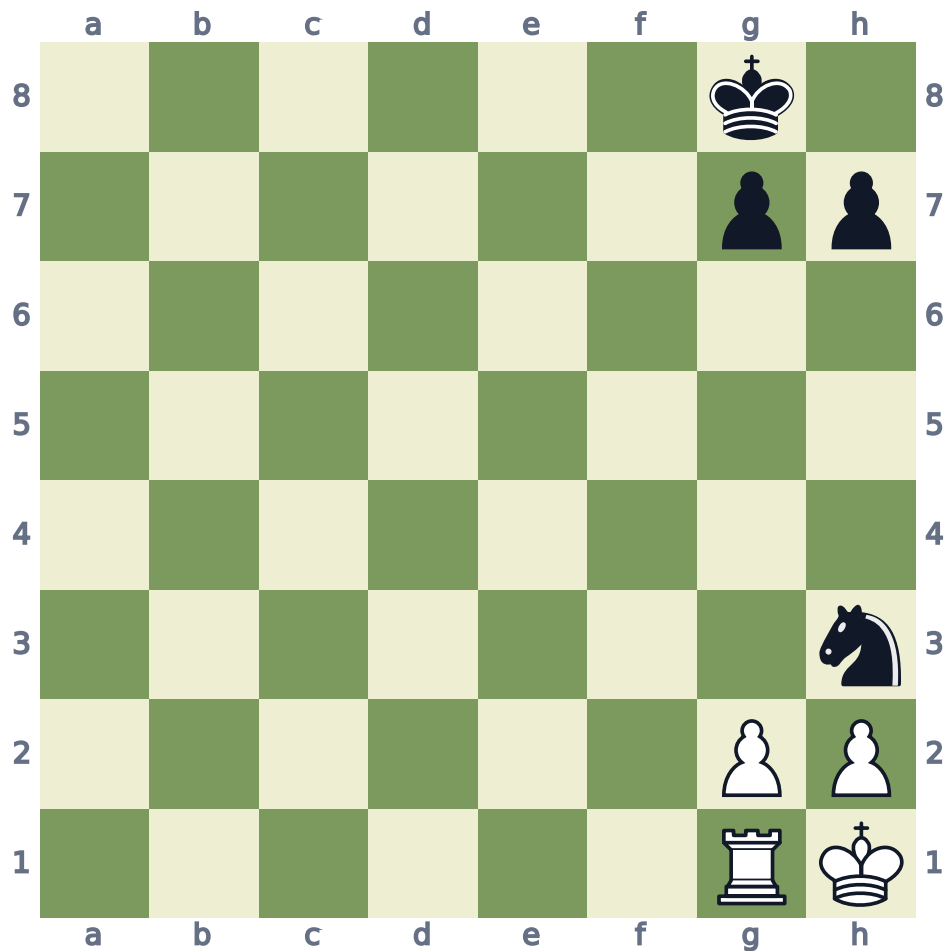
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 24

Stop Smothered mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

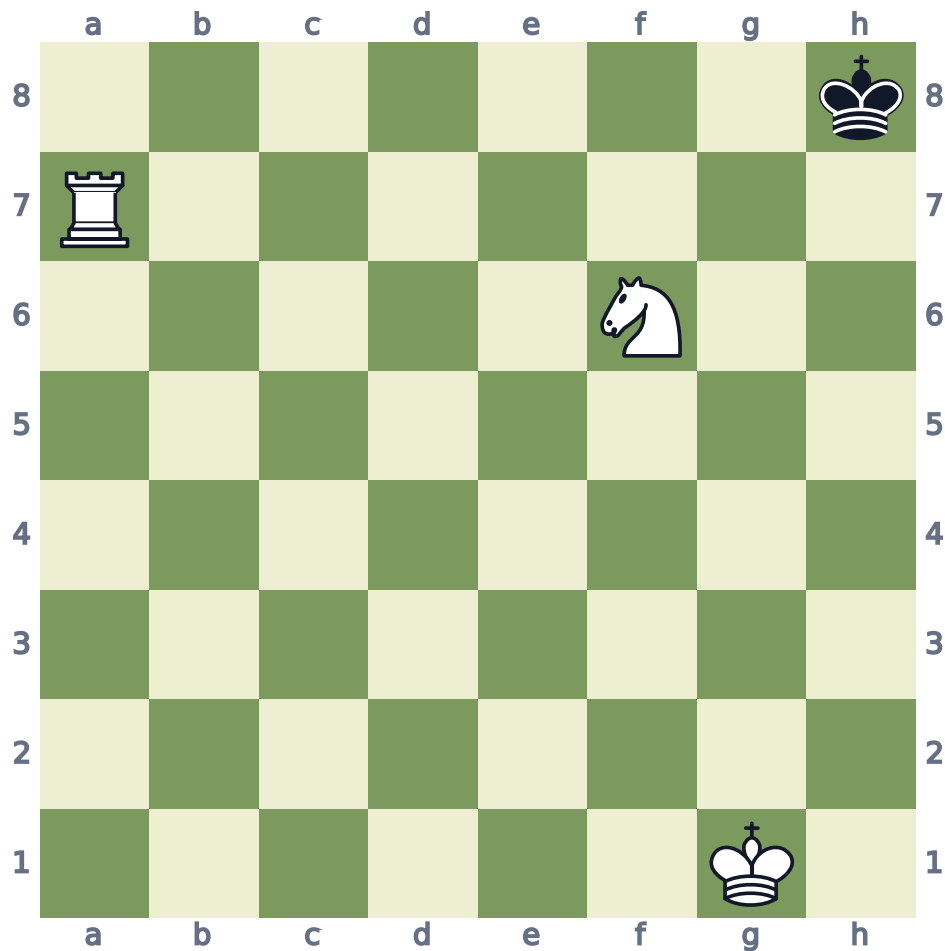
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 24

Stop Arabian mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

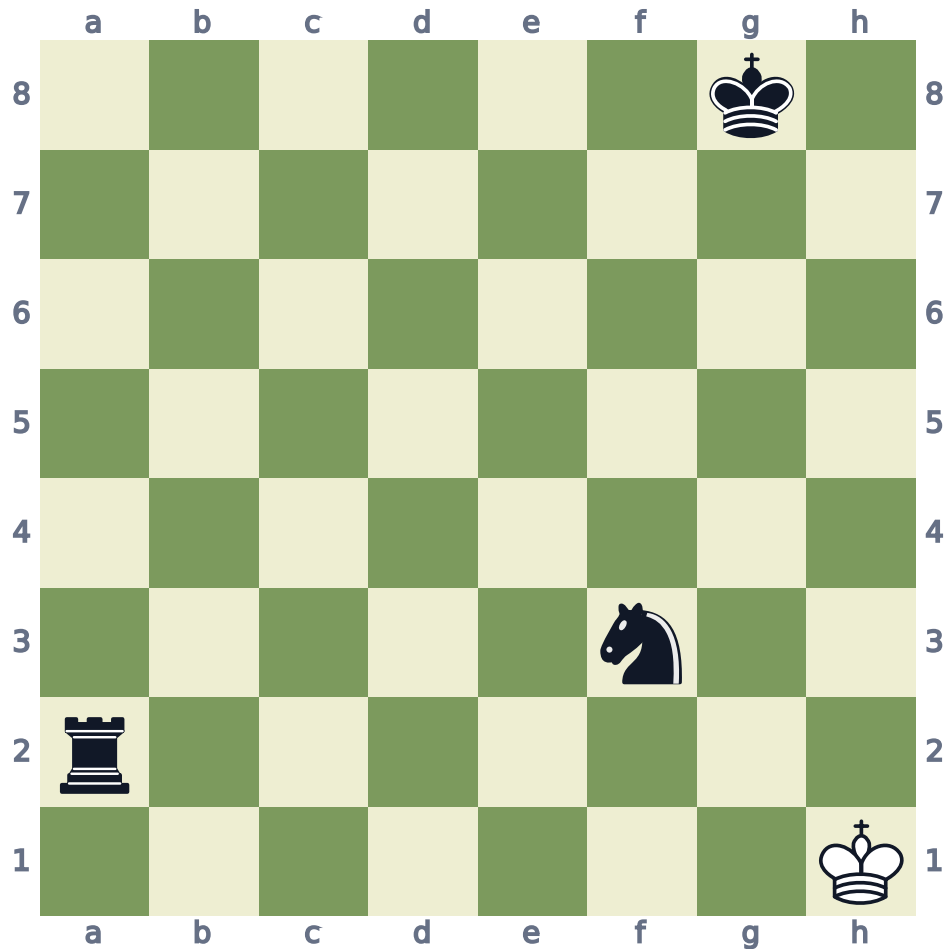
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 24

Stop Arabian mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

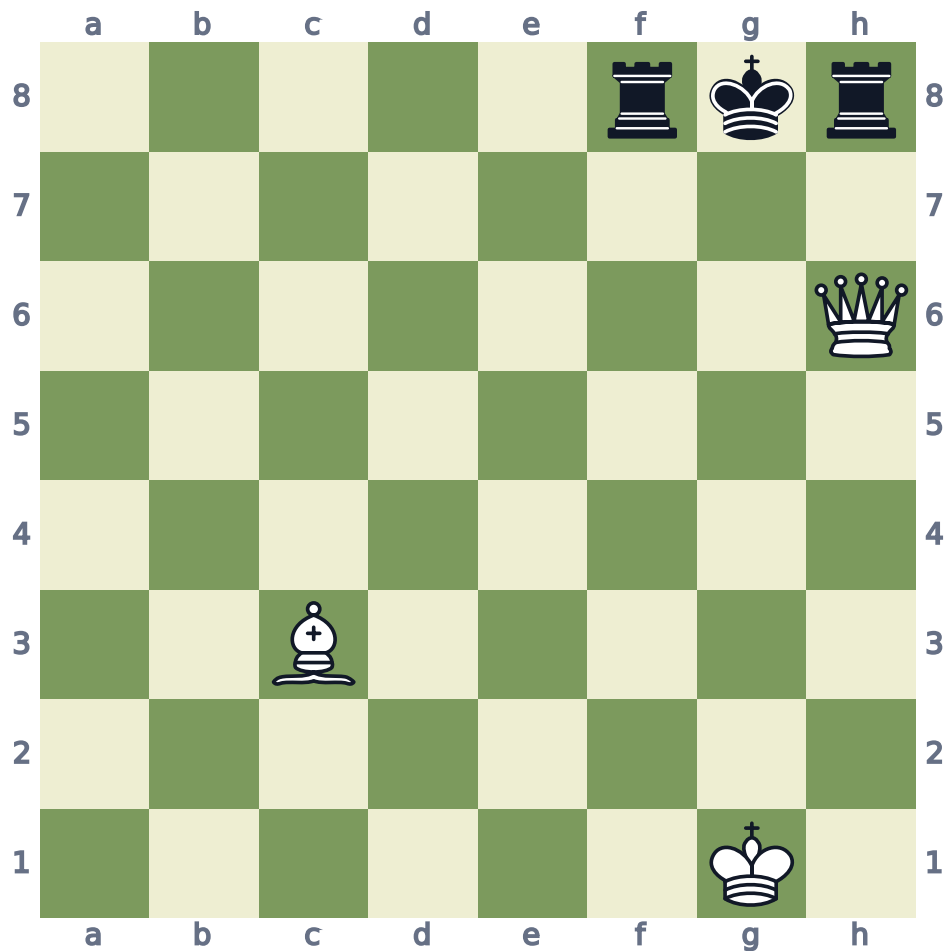
Foundation

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 24

Stop Epaulette mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

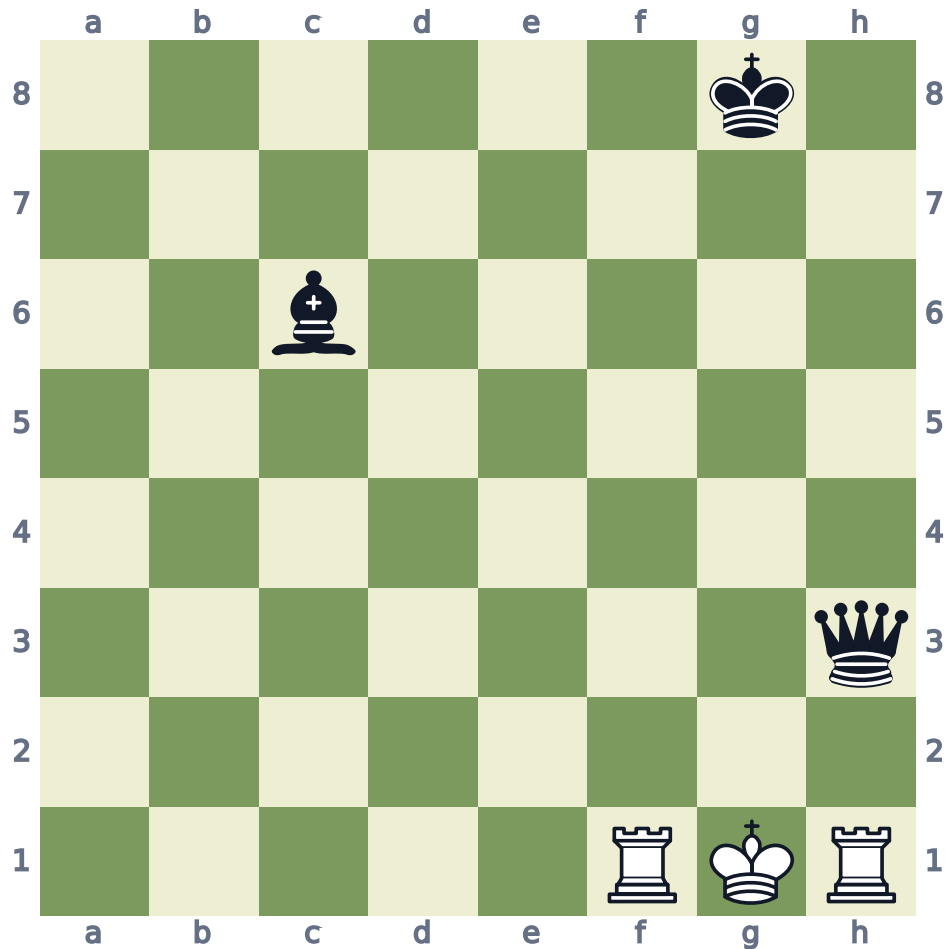
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 24

Stop Epaulette mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

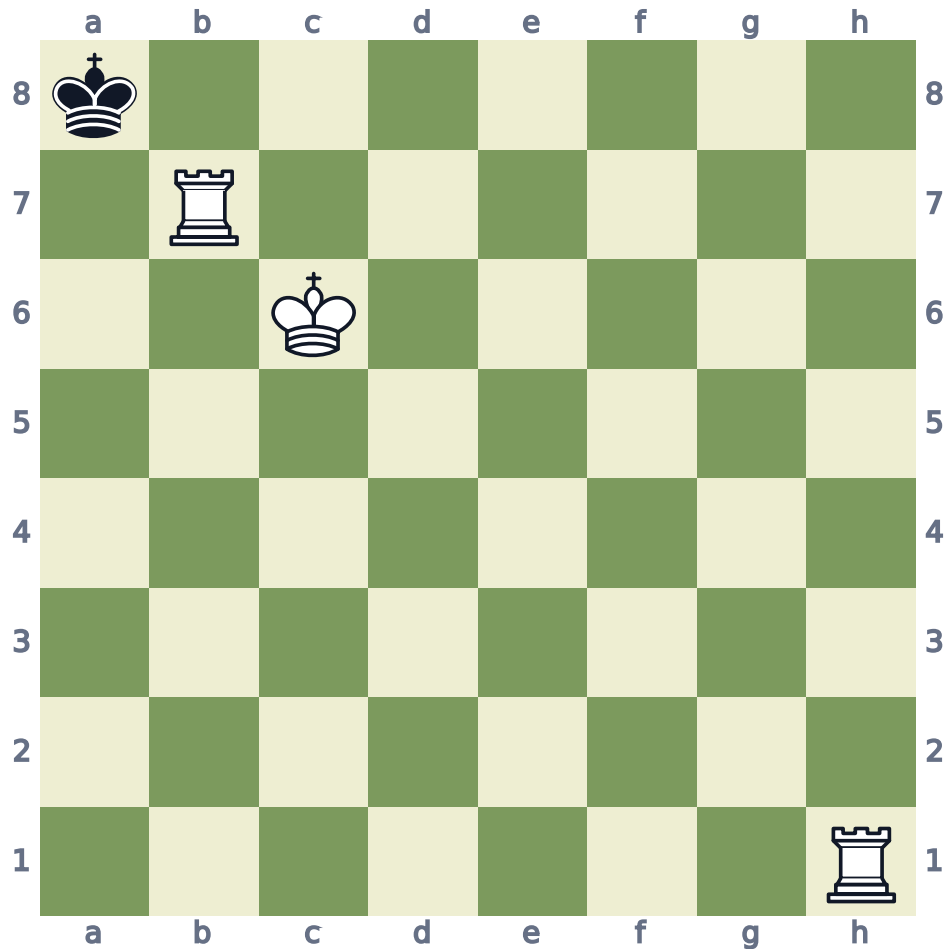
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 24

Stop Ladder mate

**YOUR TASK**

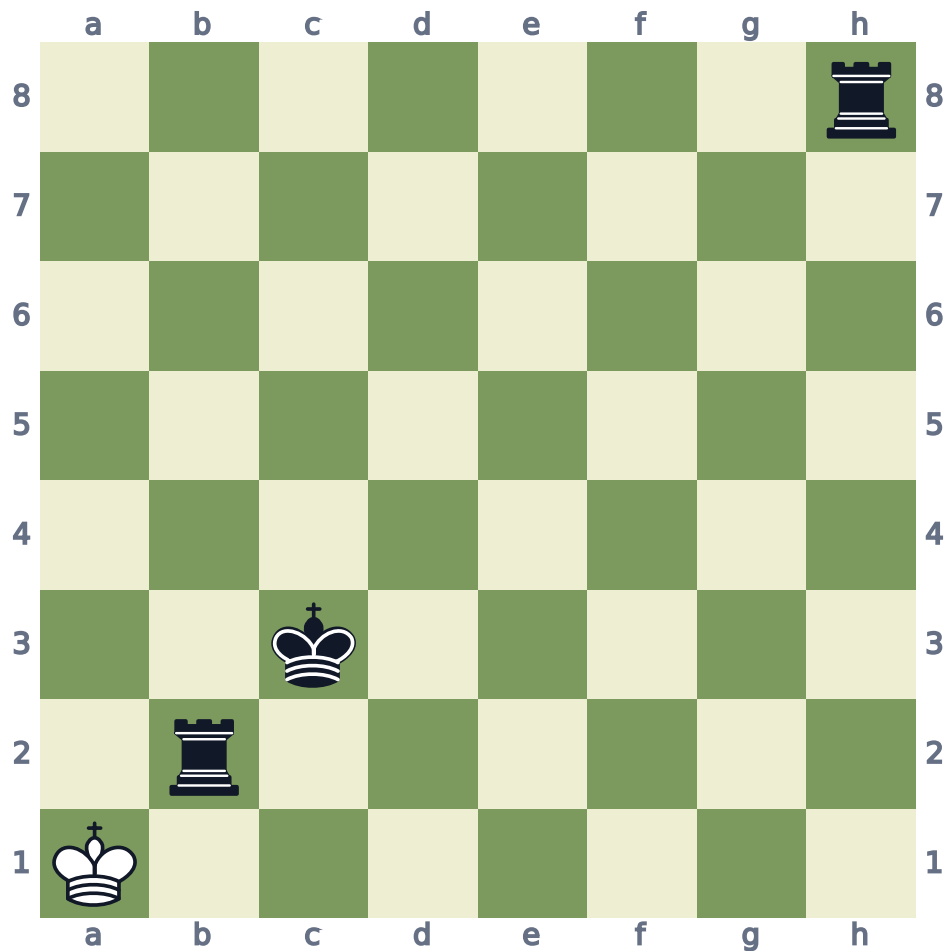
The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY**Developing****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 24

Stop Ladder mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

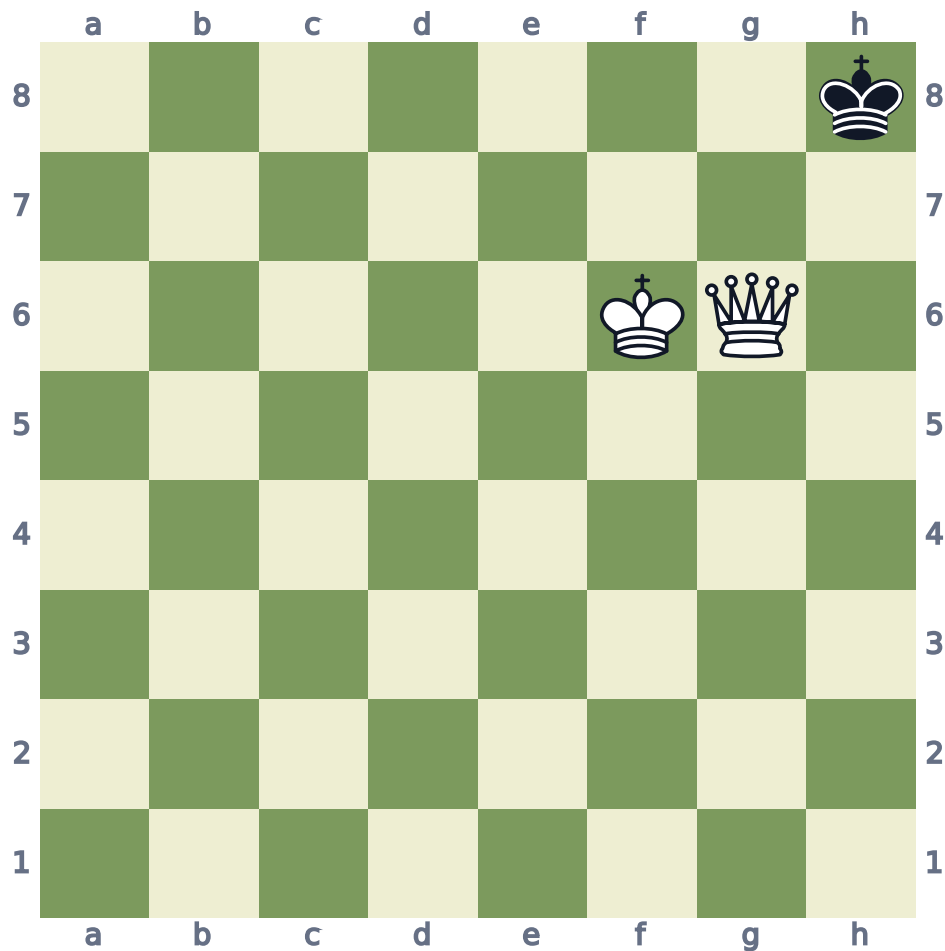
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 24

Stop Queen box mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

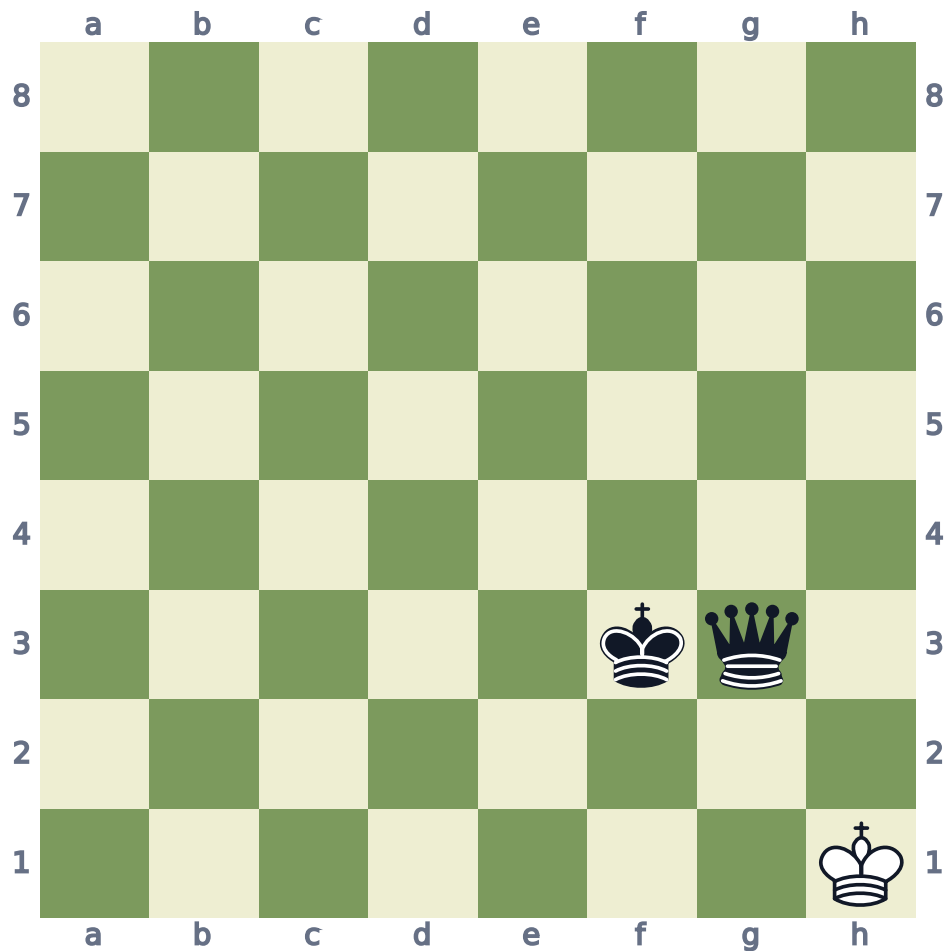
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 24

Stop Queen box mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

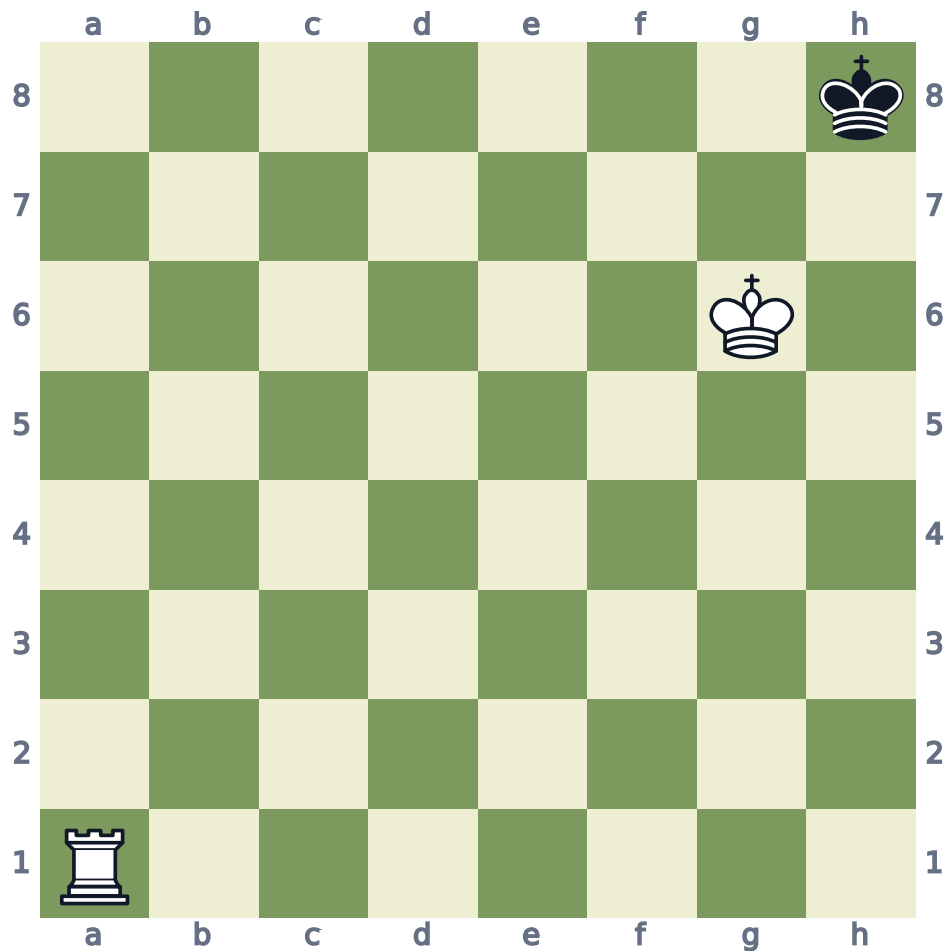
Developing

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 24

Stop Rook box mate

**YOUR TASK**

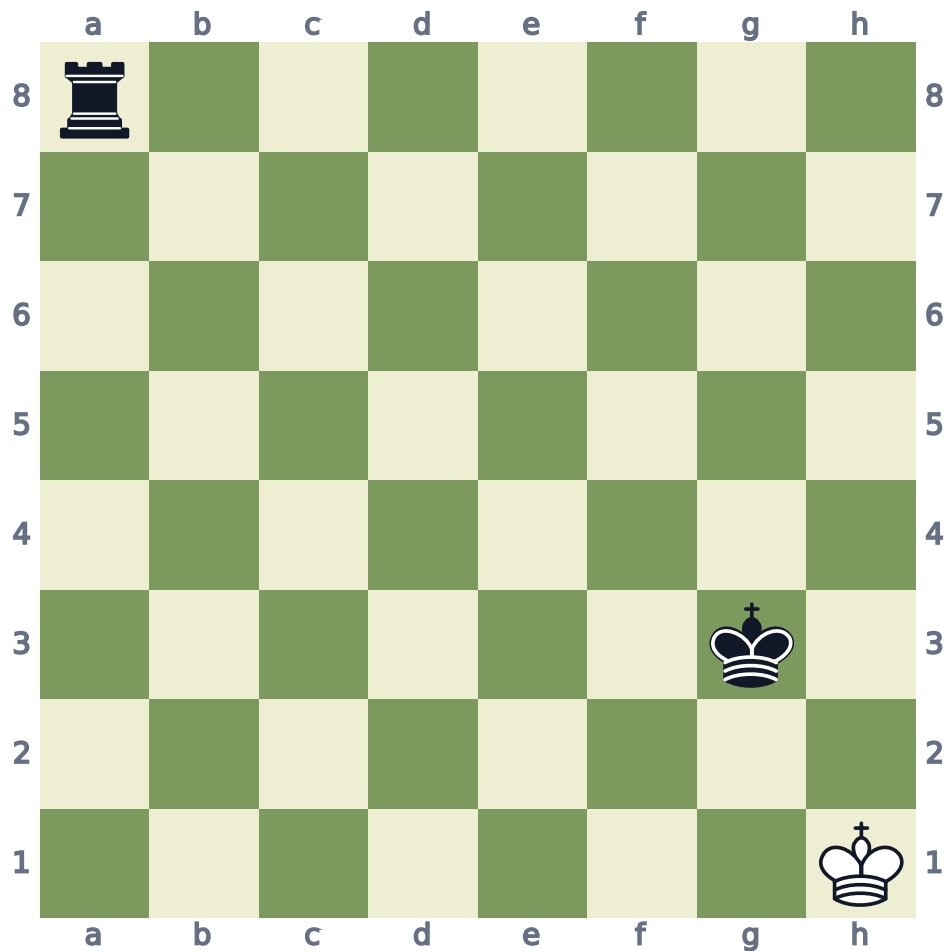
The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY**Intermediate****BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION**

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 24

Stop Rook box mate - reversed colors

**YOUR TASK**

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

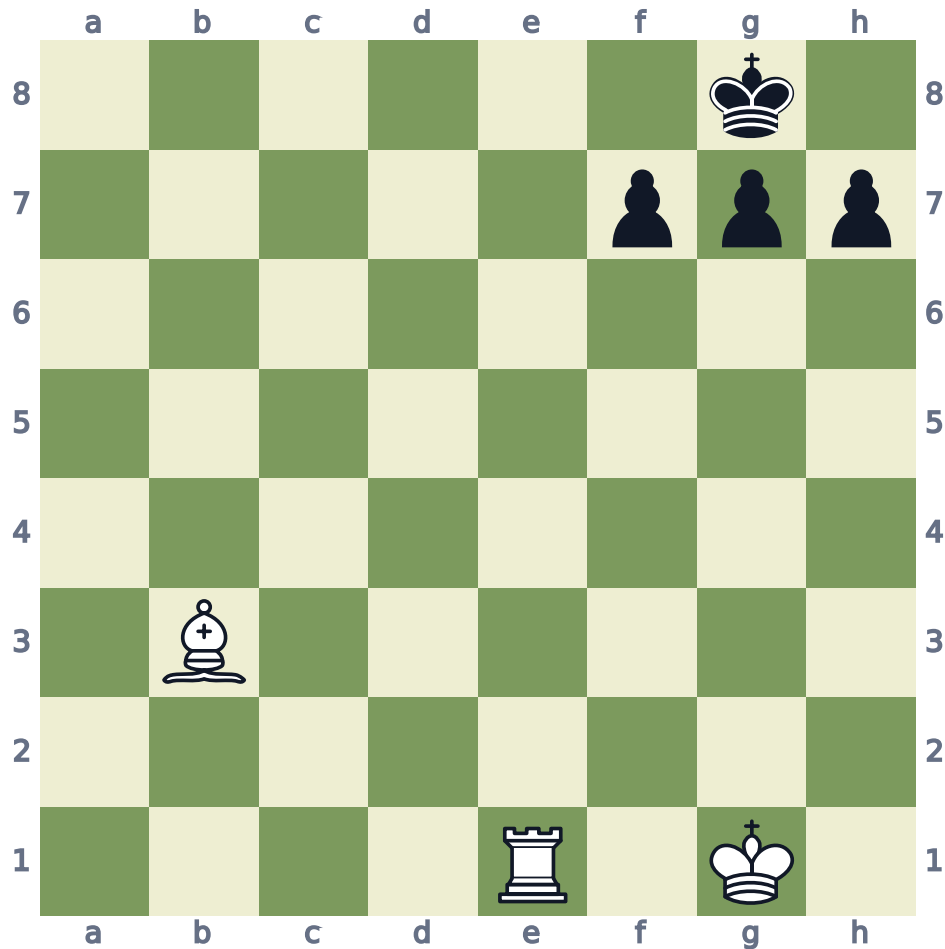
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop back rank



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

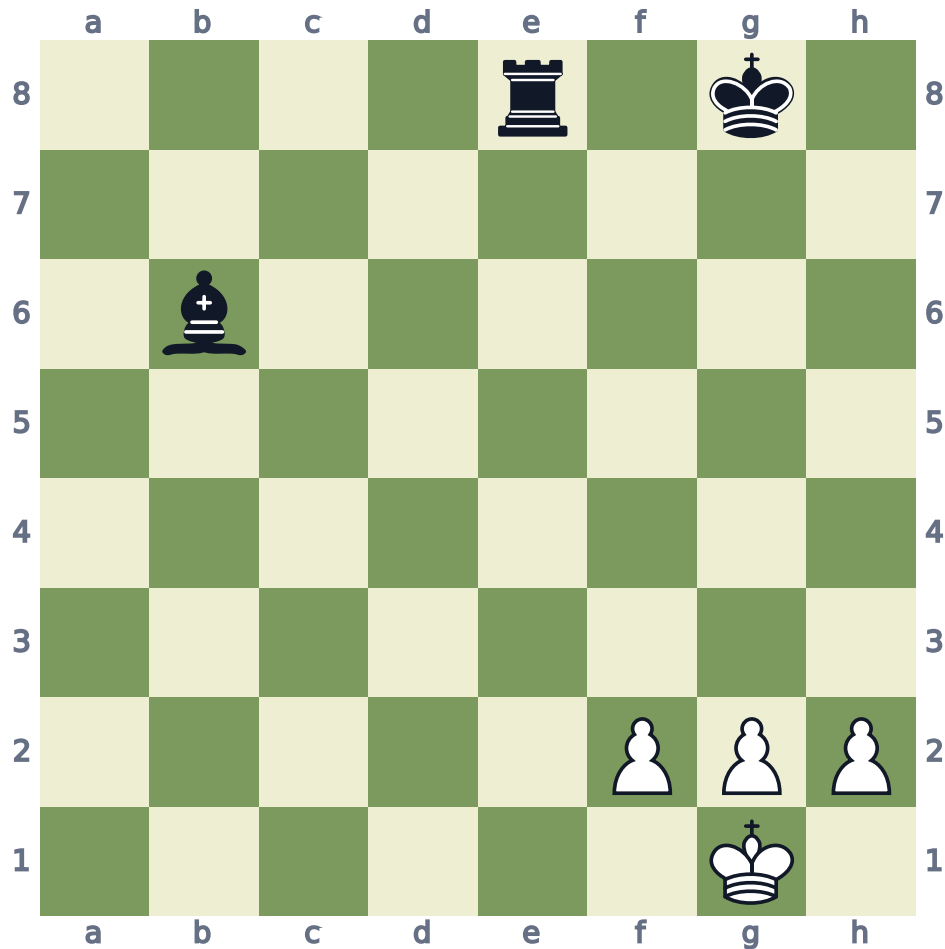
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

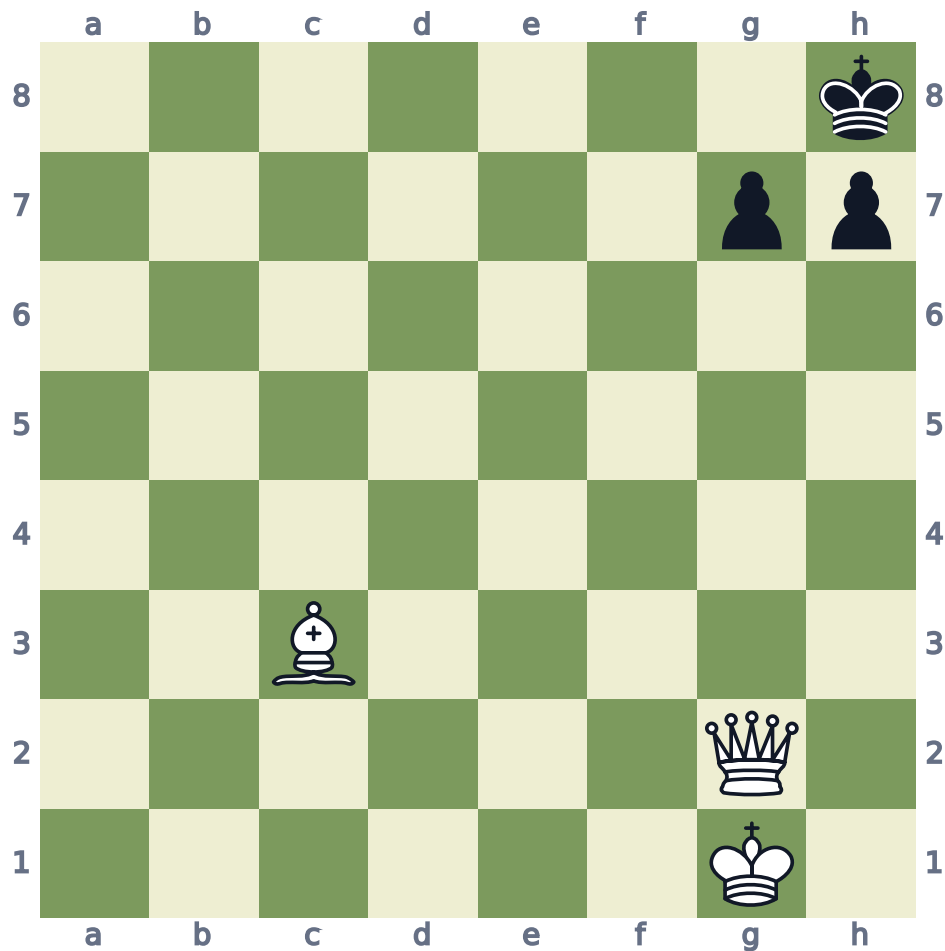
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-bishop battery



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

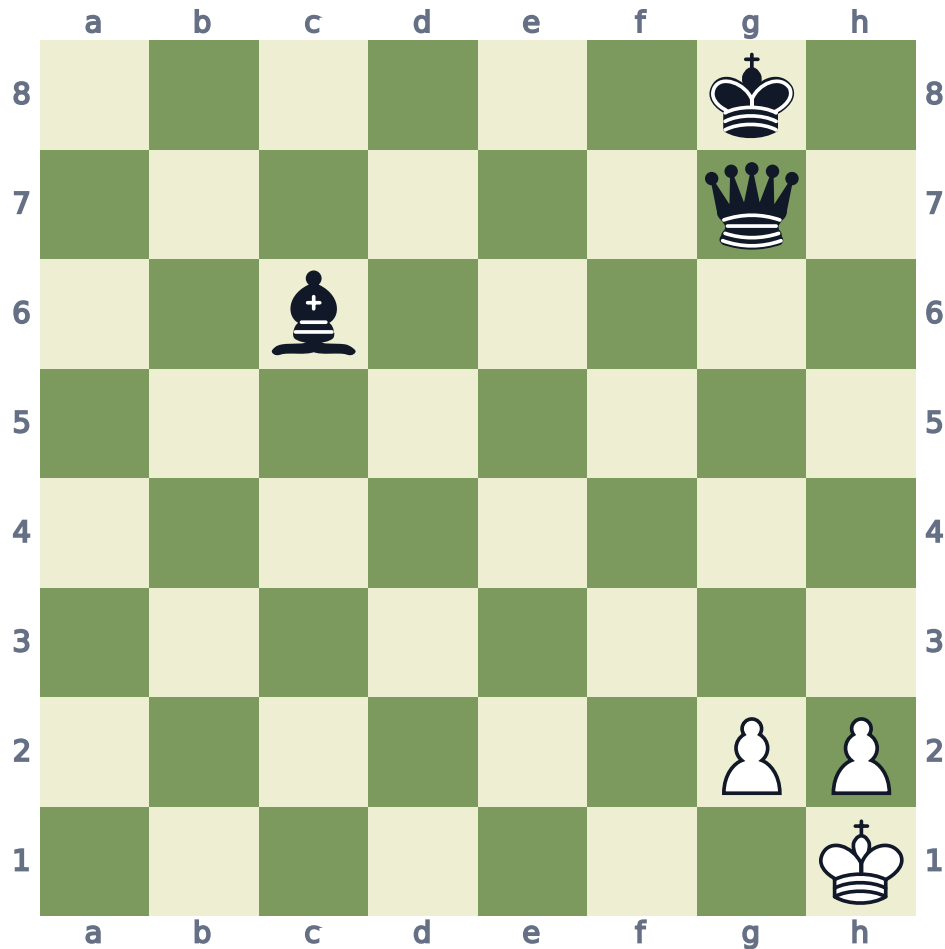
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-bishop battery - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

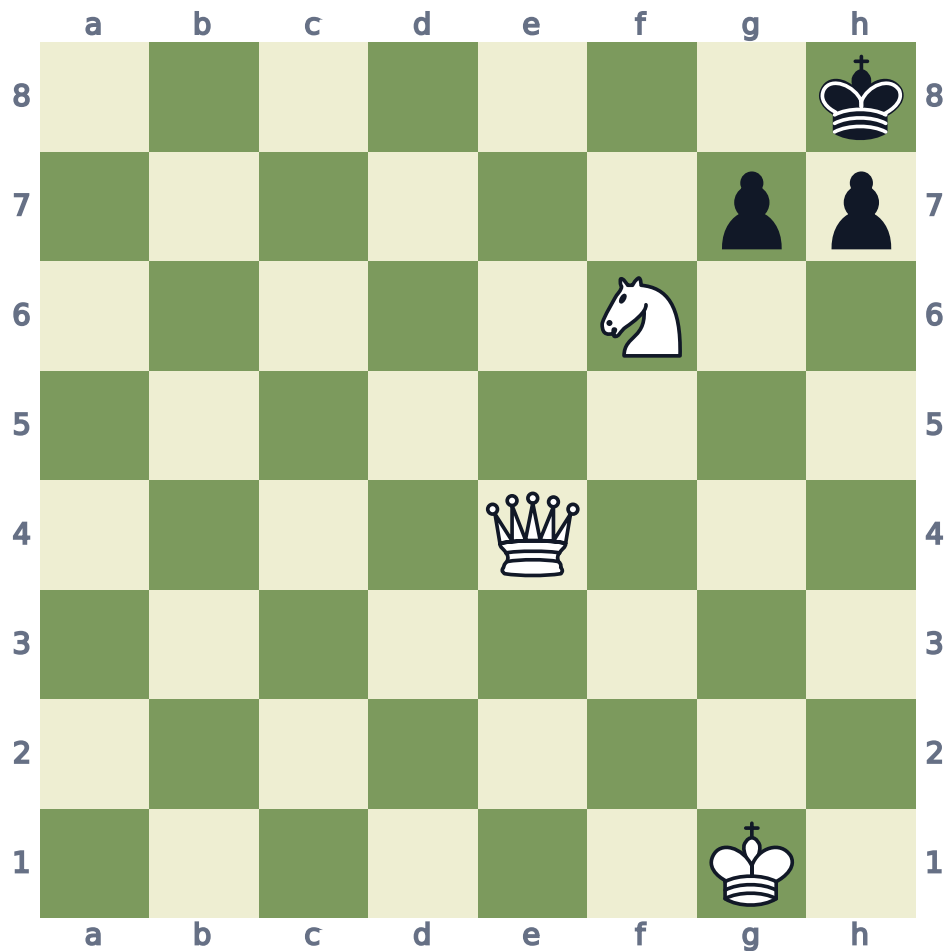
Intermediate

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-knight mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

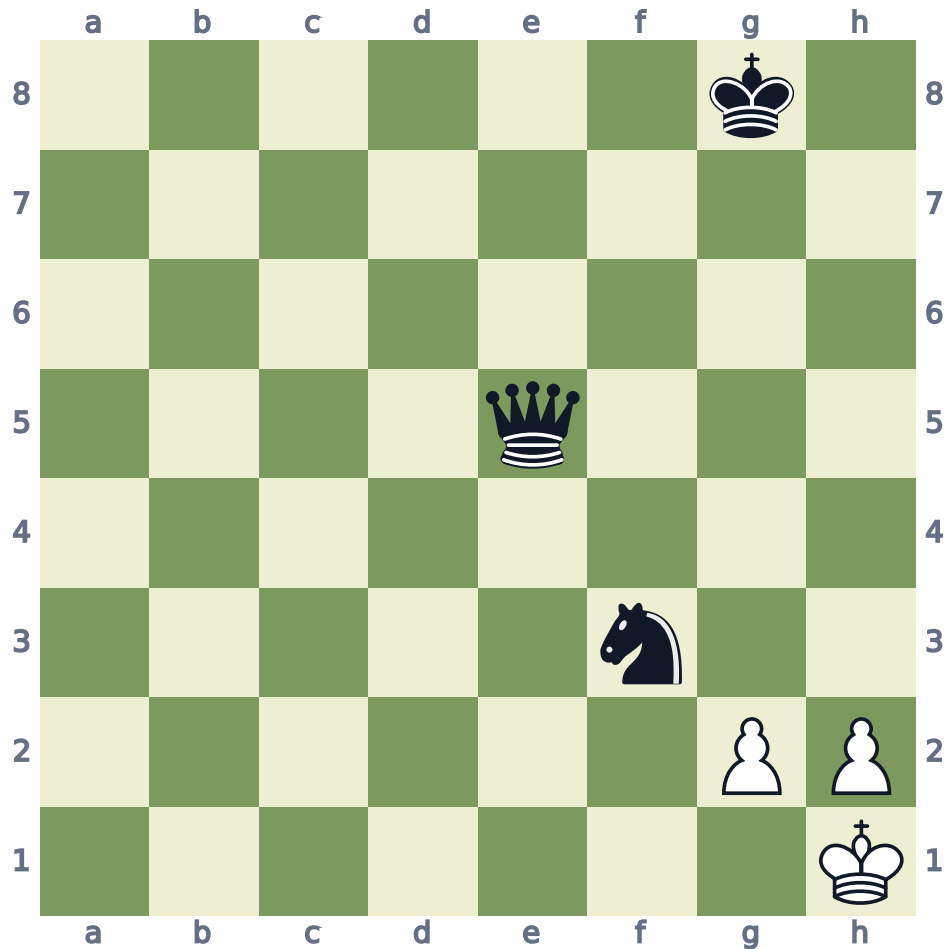
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-knight mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

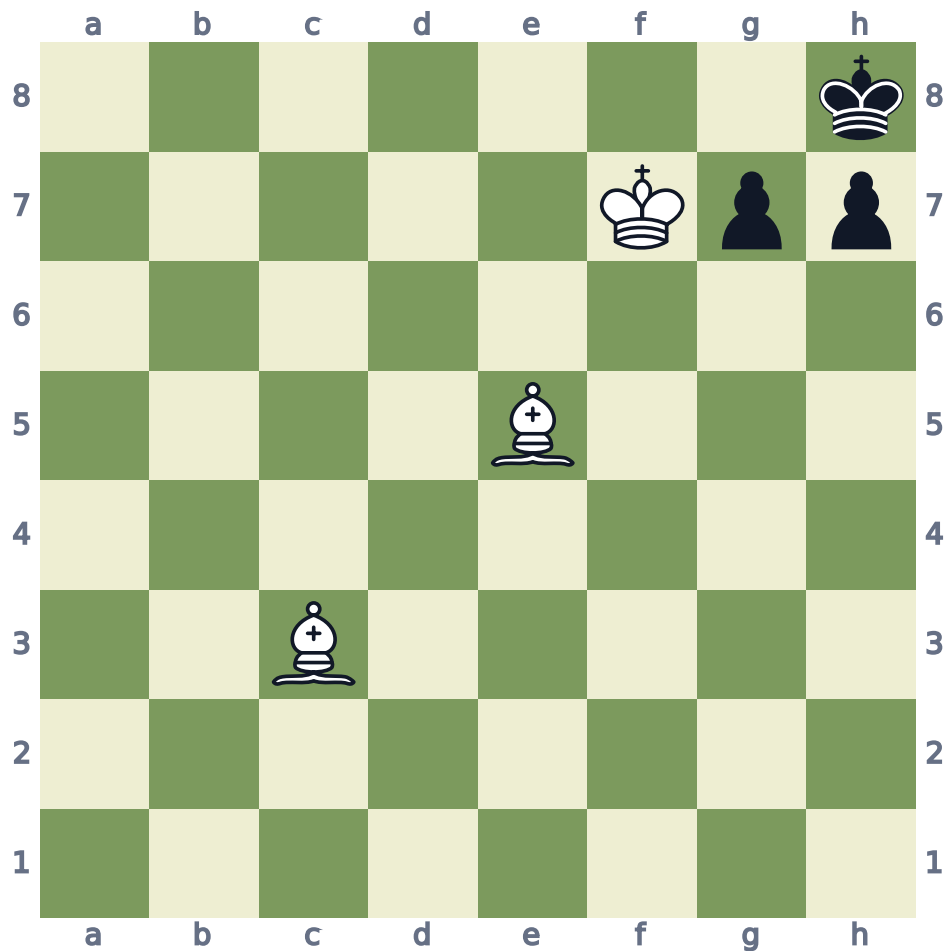
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 21 OF 24

Stop Double-bishop mate



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

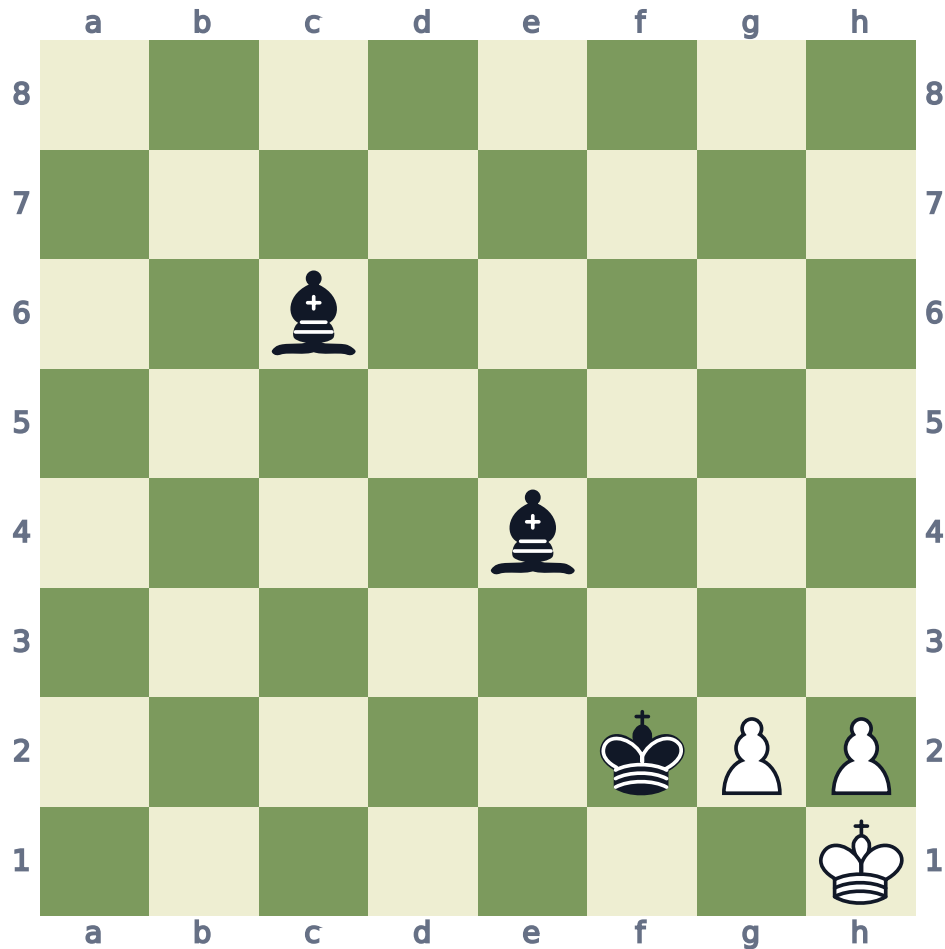
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 22 OF 24

Stop Double-bishop mate - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

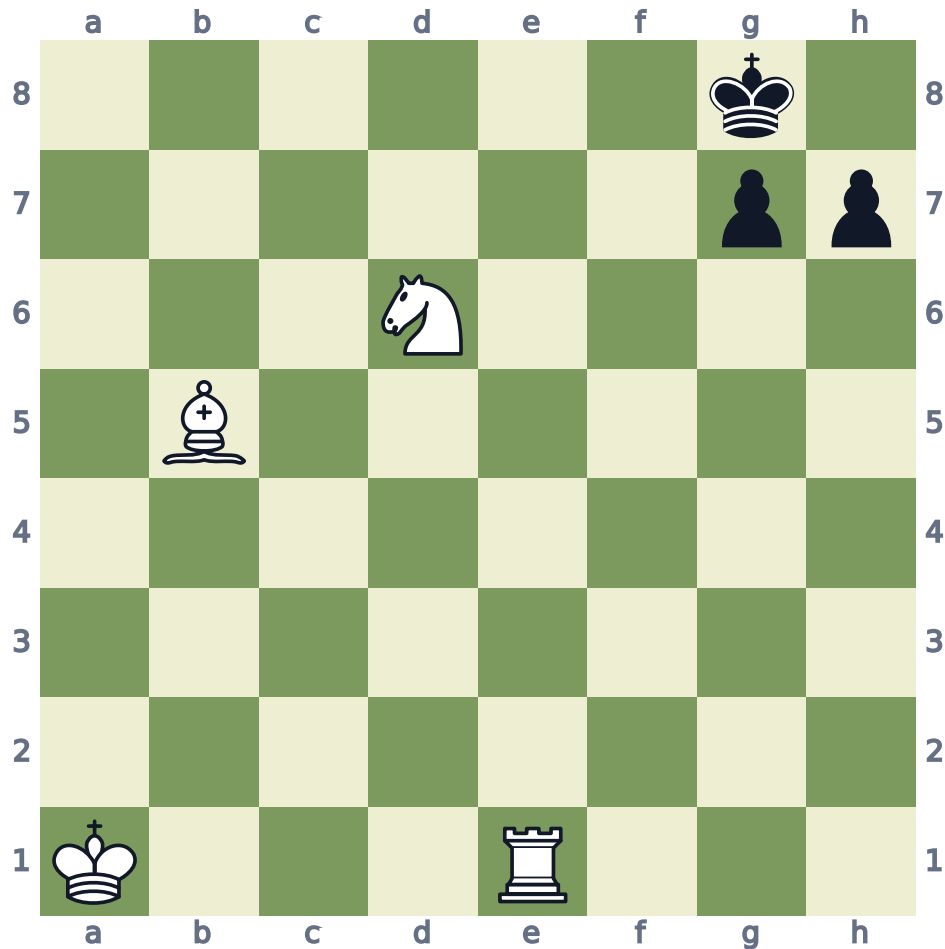
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 23 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop corridor



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

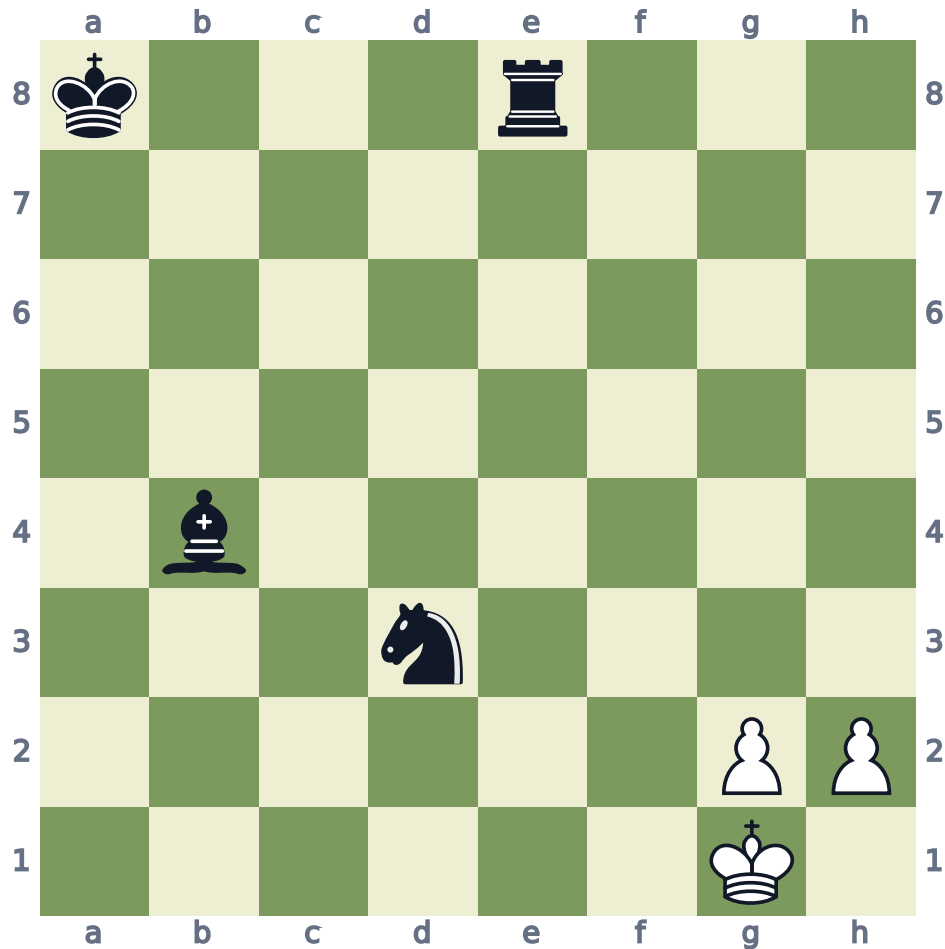
Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 24 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop corridor - reversed colors



YOUR TASK

The opponent threatens a mating pattern. Find the most resilient defense. Consider capture, exchange, block, flight square, countercheck, material return, and counterattack before choosing.

DIFFICULTY

Advanced club

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

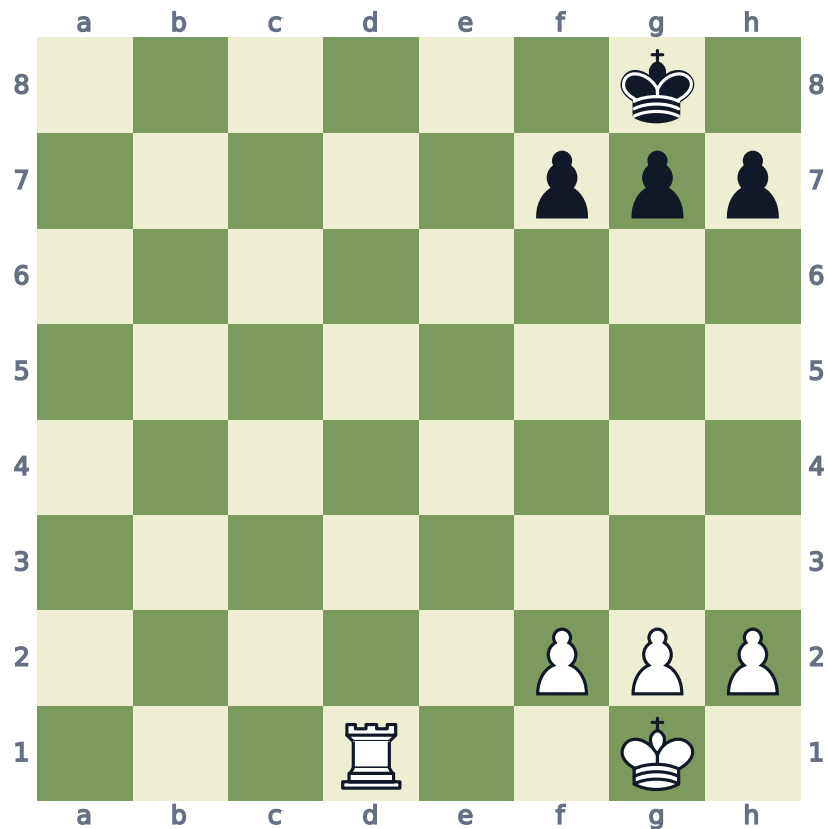
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 24

Stop Back-rank mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. g6 f3 2. g5 Rd8+ 3. Kg7 g3 4. f6

WHY IT WORKS

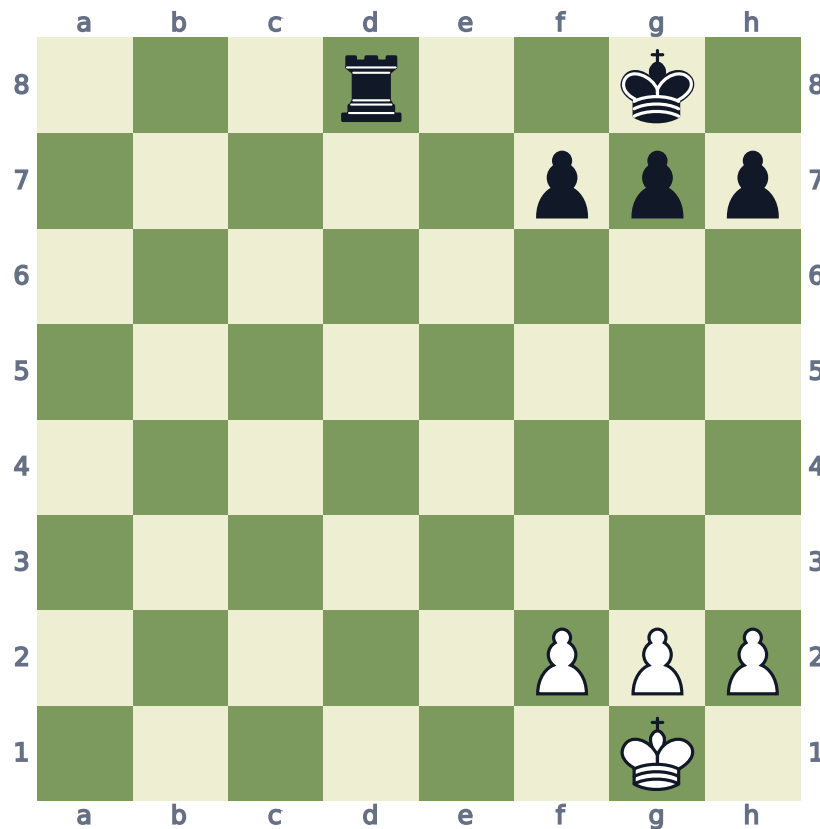
The original attacking picture was Back-rank mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to create flight. The second engine candidate scores -6.34 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.08.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.26 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 02 OF 24

Stop Back-rank mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. f3 Re8 2. h3 Rd8 3. g3 h5 4. f4

WHY IT WORKS

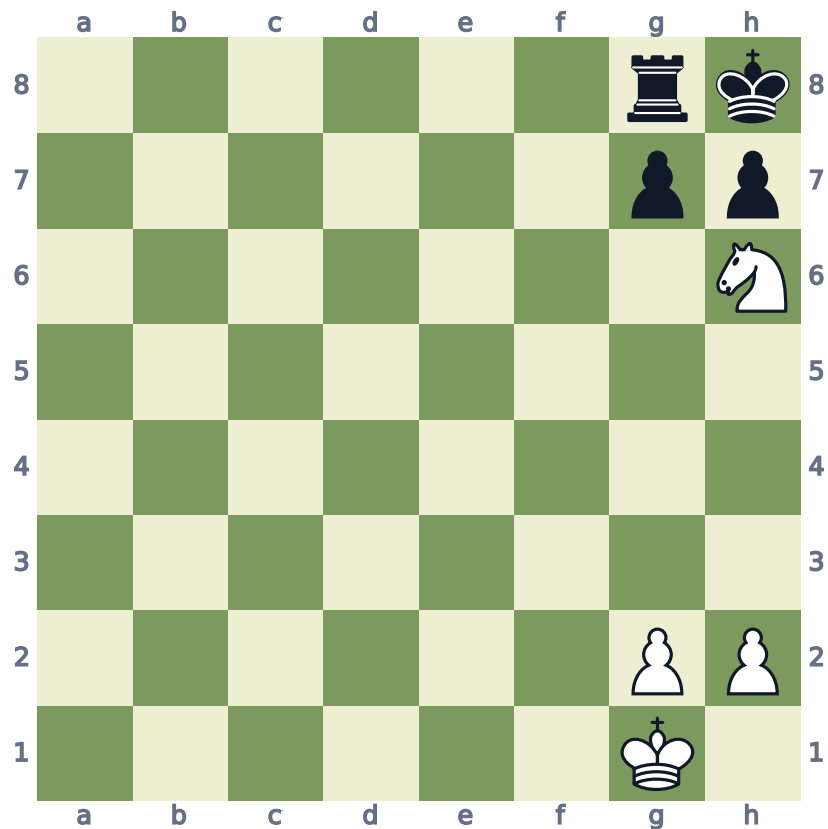
The original attacking picture was Back-rank mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to trade the attacker. The second engine candidate scores -6.68 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.21.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.47 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 03 OF 24

Stop Smothered mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. gxh6 Kh1 2. Ra8 h3 3. Ra1+ Kh2 4. Rc1 Kg3 5. h5 Kf2

WHY IT WORKS

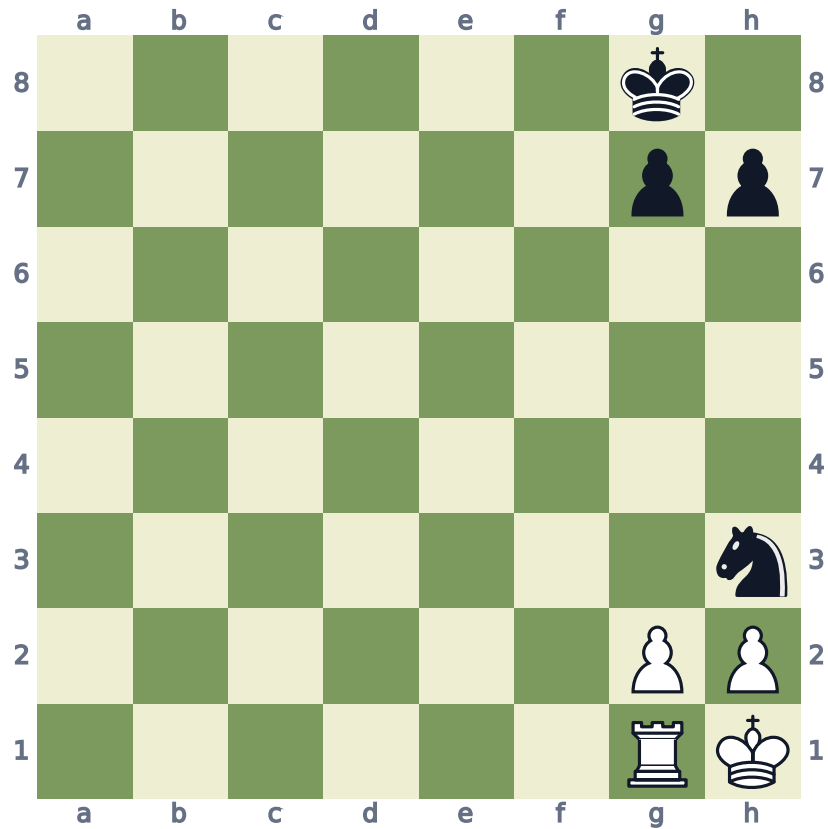
The original attacking picture was Smothered mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to countercheck. The second engine candidate scores +3.02 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 2.48.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.50 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 04 OF 24

Stop Smothered mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. gxh3 Kh8 2. Re1 Kg8 3. h4 Kf7 4. Ra1 Kg8 5. Ra8+ Kf7

WHY IT WORKS

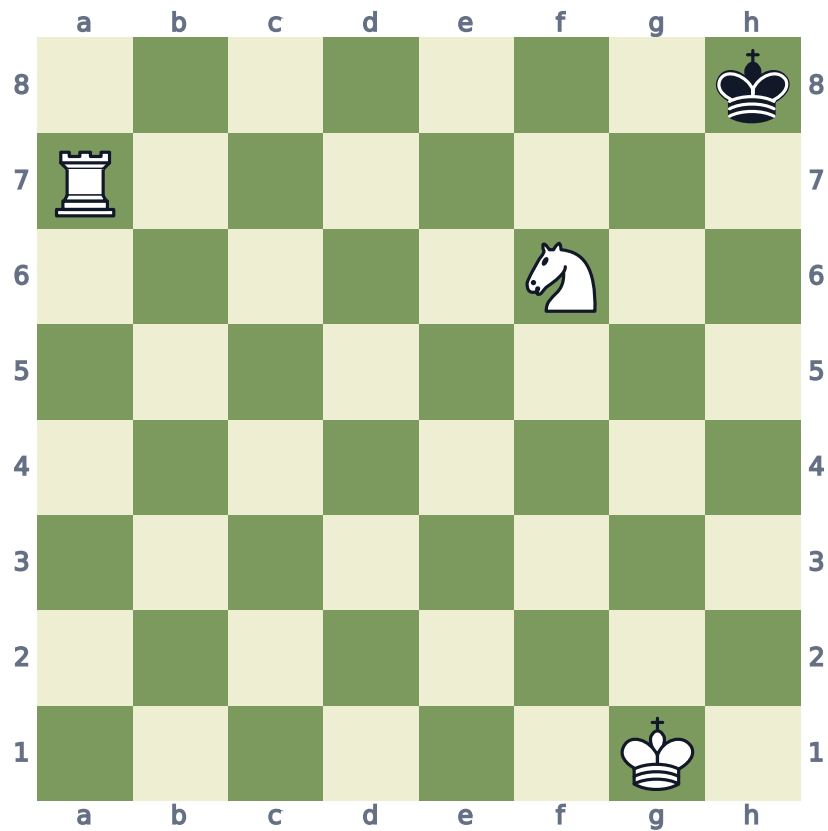
The original attacking picture was Smothered mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to return material. The second engine candidate scores +3.00 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 2.41.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.41 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 05 OF 24

Stop Arabian mate



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

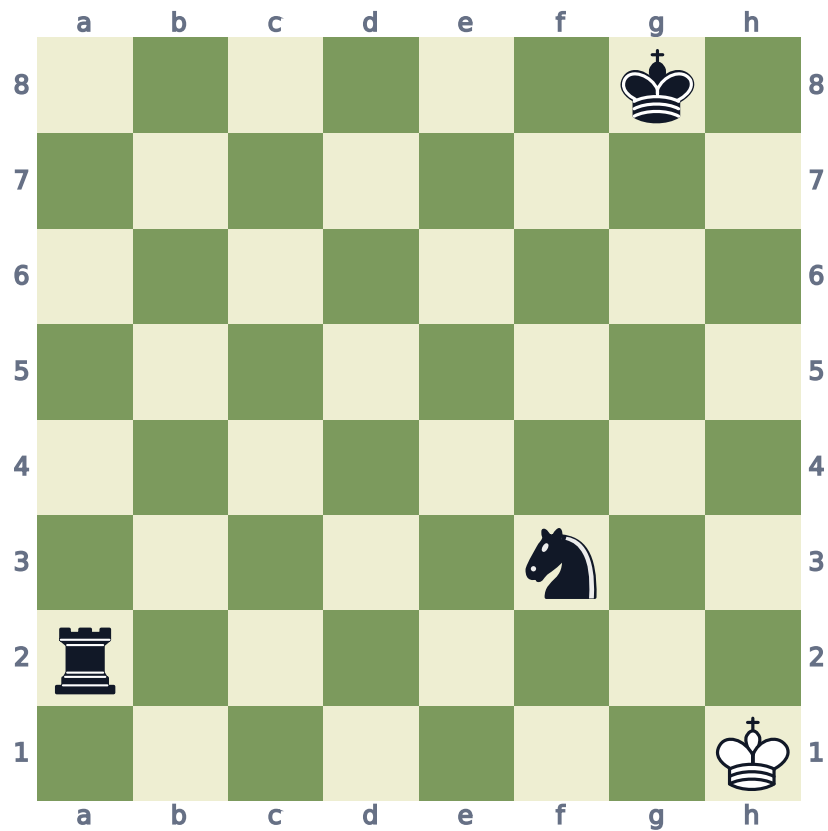
The original attacking picture was Arabian mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to block the line.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 06 OF 24

Stop Arabian mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

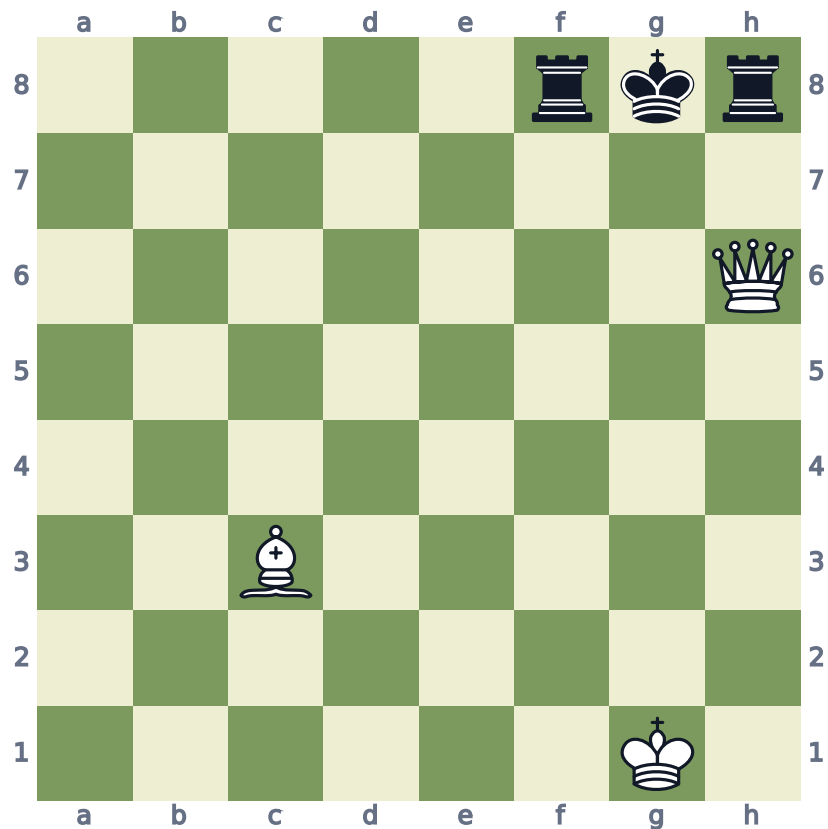
The original attacking picture was Arabian mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to remove the key attacker.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 07 OF 24

Stop Epaulette mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rxh6 Be5 2. Rg6+ Kh2 3. Rf2+ Kh3

WHY IT WORKS

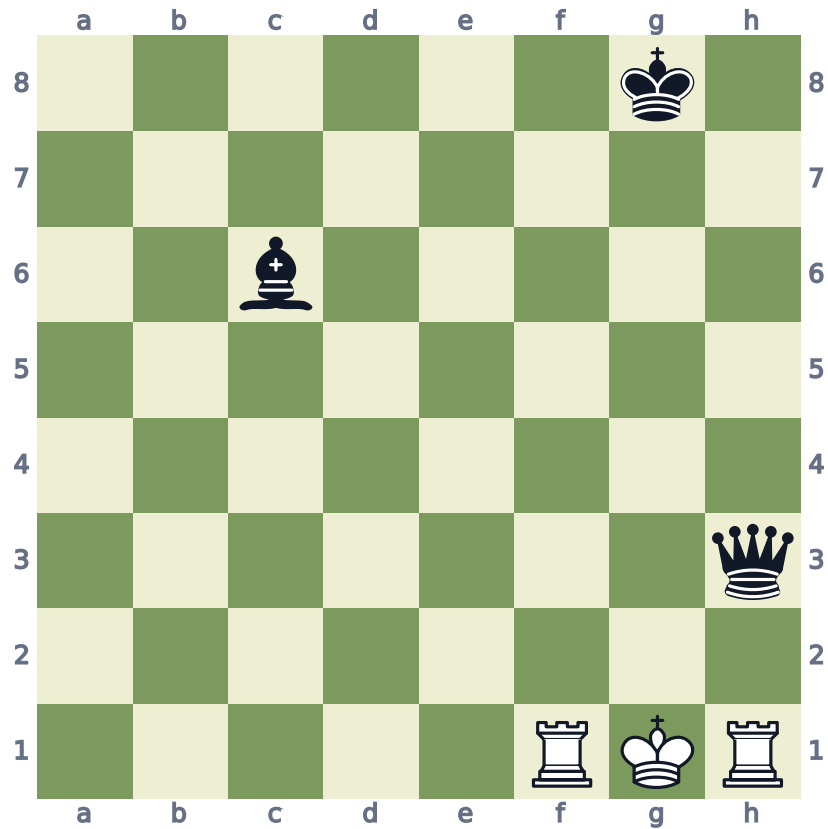
The original attacking picture was Epaulette mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to create flight. The second engine candidate scores +0.08 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 5.30.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.38 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 08 OF 24

Stop Epaulette mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rxh3 Bb5 2. Rc3 Kg7 3. Rf5 Be2 4. Rf2 Bh5 5. Rc8

WHY IT WORKS

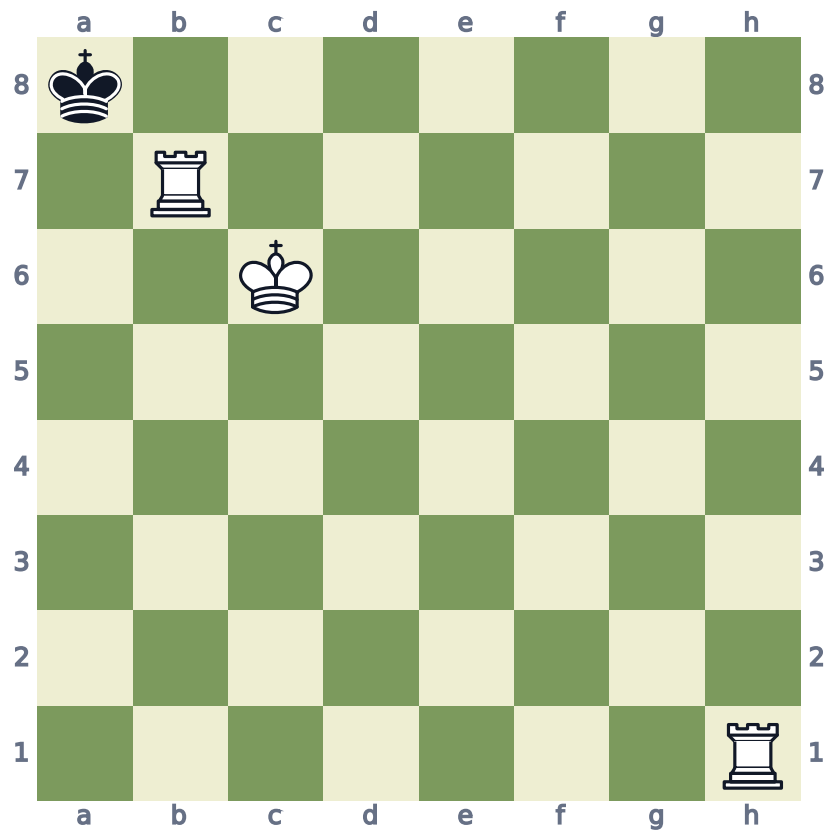
The original attacking picture was Epaulette mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to trade the attacker. The second engine candidate scores +0.20 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 4.87.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +5.07 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 09 OF 24

Stop Ladder mate



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

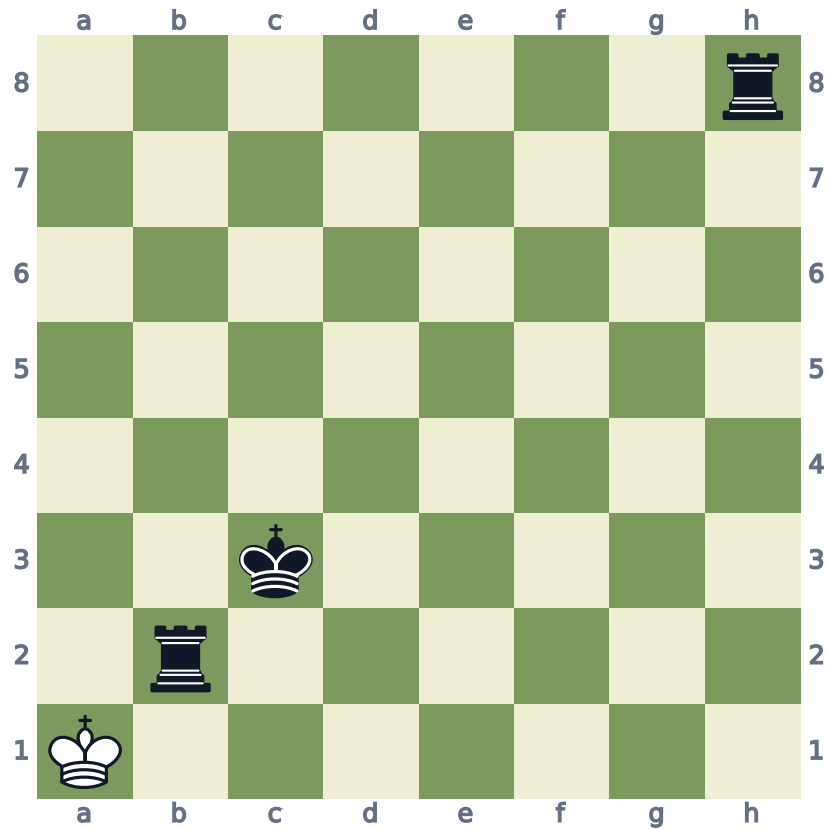
The original attacking picture was Ladder mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to countercheck.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 10 OF 24

Stop Ladder mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

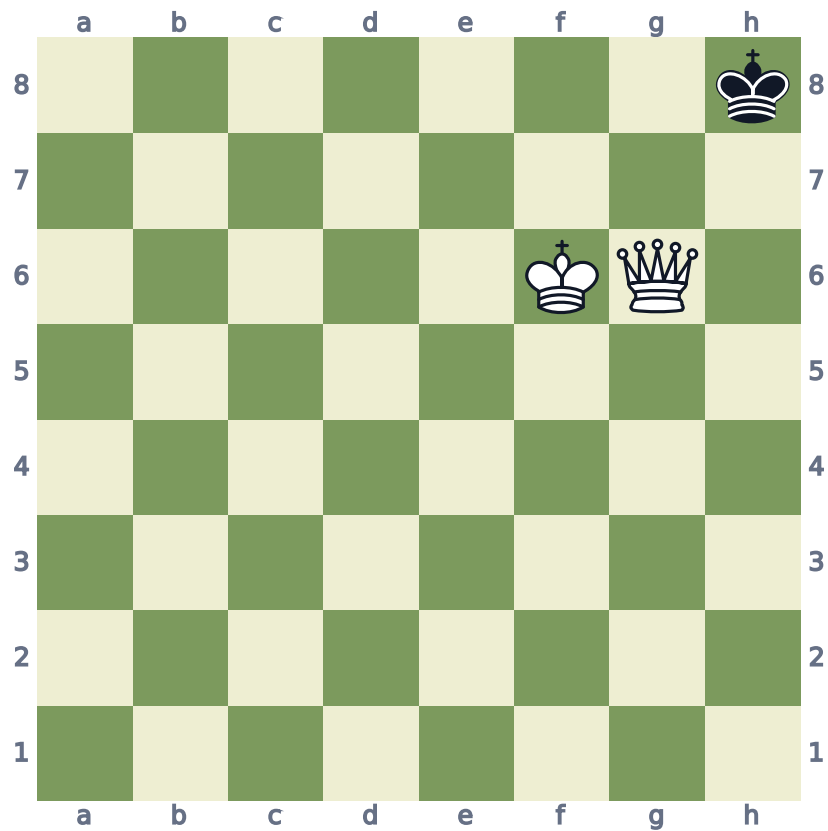
The original attacking picture was Ladder mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to return material.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 11 OF 24

Stop Queen box mate



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

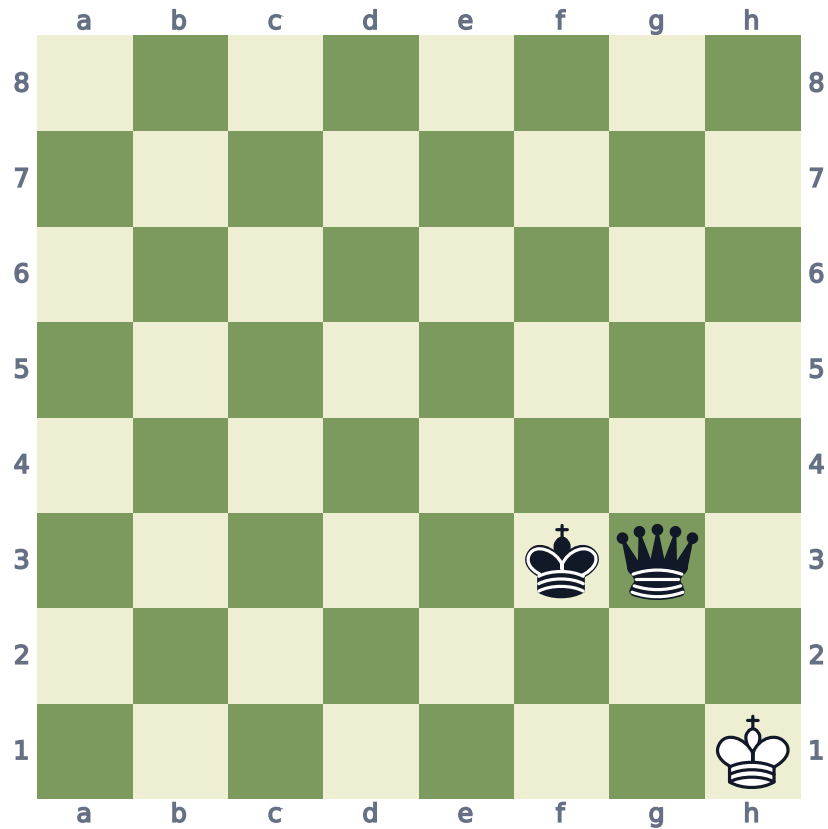
The original attacking picture was Queen box mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to block the line.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 12 OF 24

Stop Queen box mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

No forcing line returned

WHY IT WORKS

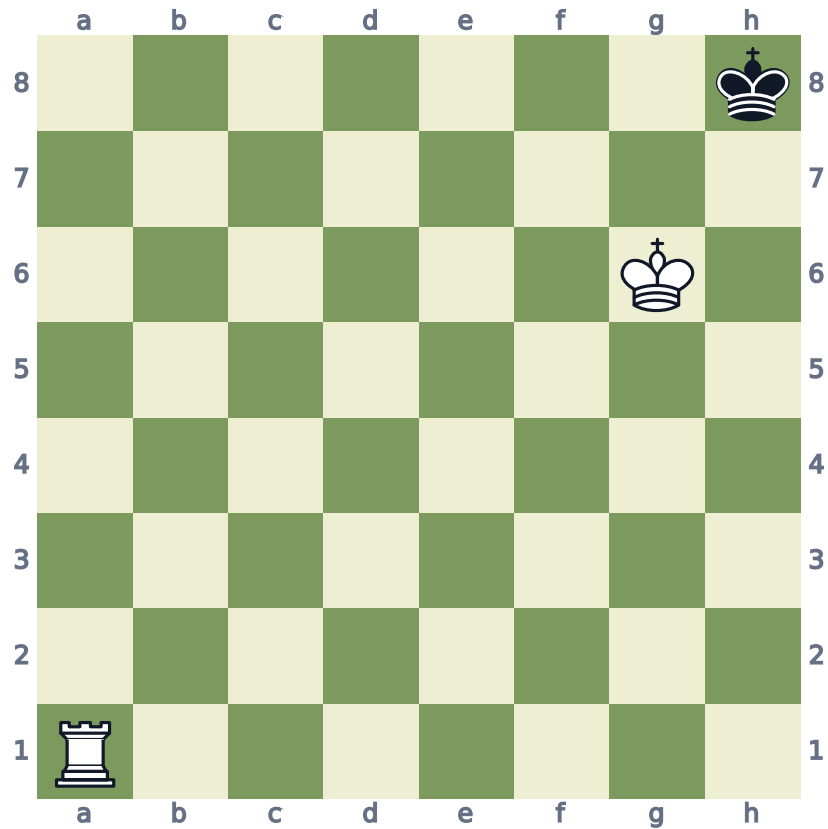
The original attacking picture was Queen box mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to remove the key attacker.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 13 OF 24

Stop Rook box mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg8 Ra8#

WHY IT WORKS

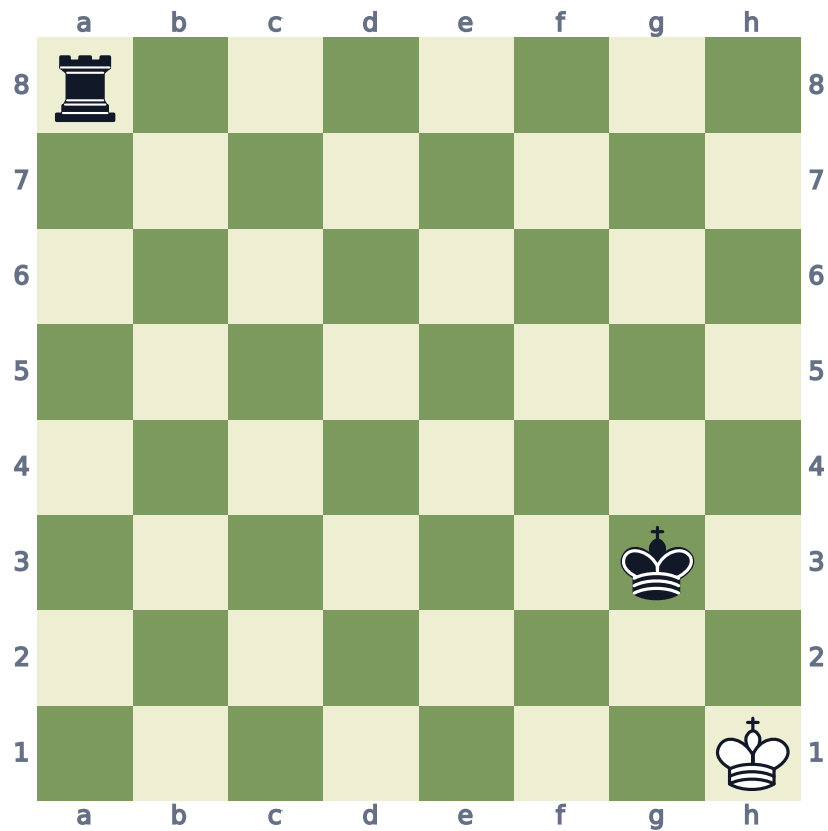
The original attacking picture was Rook box mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to create flight.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: being mated in 1.

SOLUTION 14 OF 24

Stop Rook box mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. Kg1 Ra1#

WHY IT WORKS

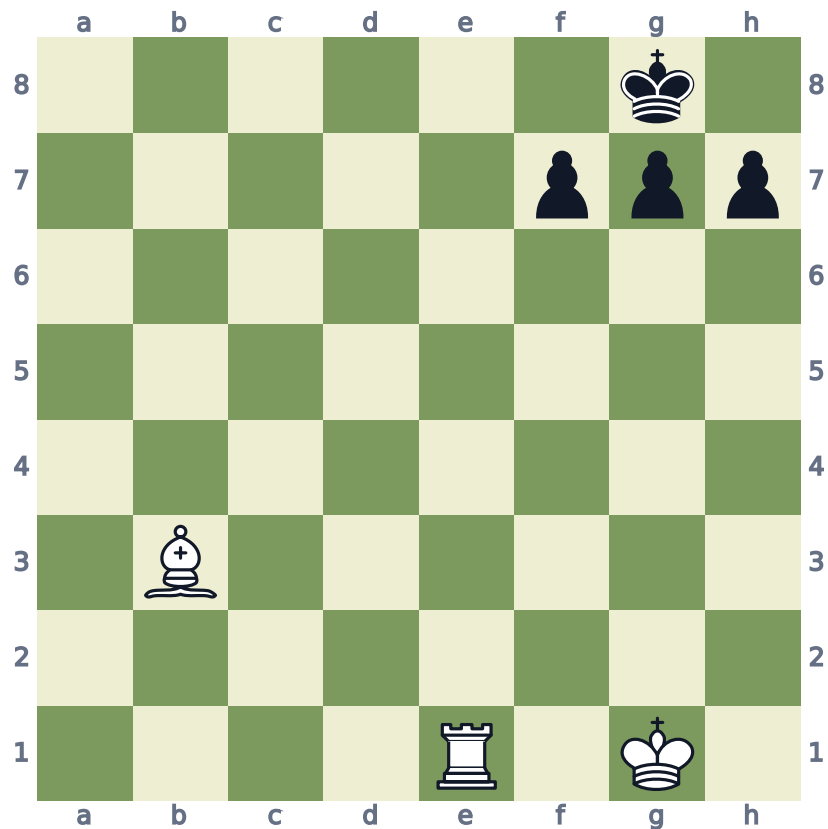
The original attacking picture was Rook box mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to trade the attacker.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: being mated in 1.

SOLUTION 15 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop back rank



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kf8 Bc4 2. g6 Re2 3. Kg7

WHY IT WORKS

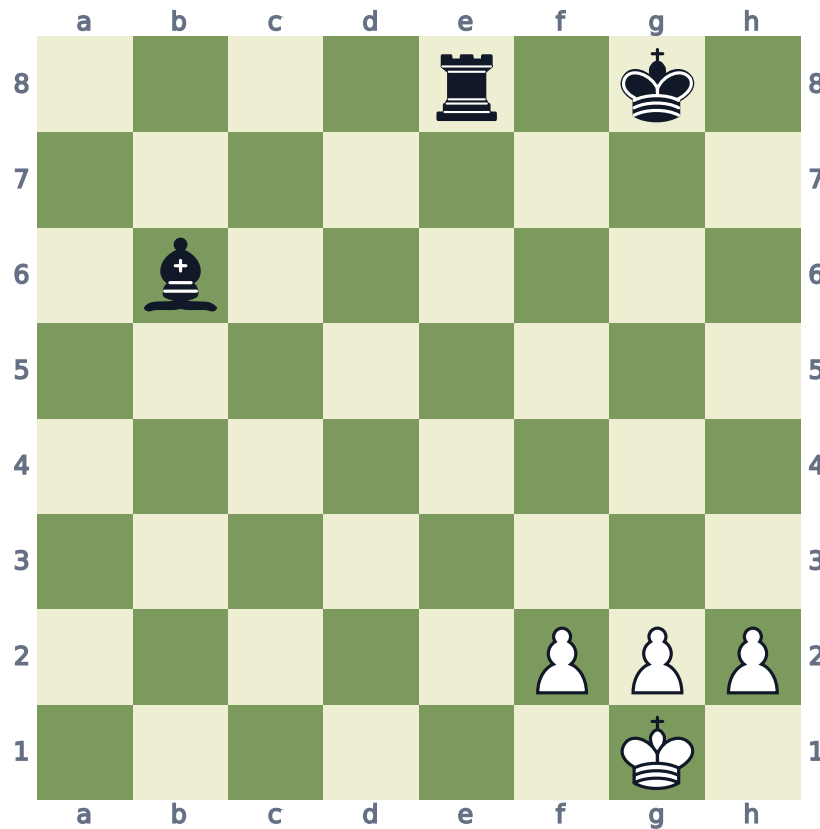
The original attacking picture was Rook-and-bishop back rank. Defensive search should begin by trying to countercheck. The second engine candidate scores -4.57 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.10.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -4.47 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 16 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop back rank - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. Kf1 Bc5 2. g3 Rf8 3. f4 Rf7

WHY IT WORKS

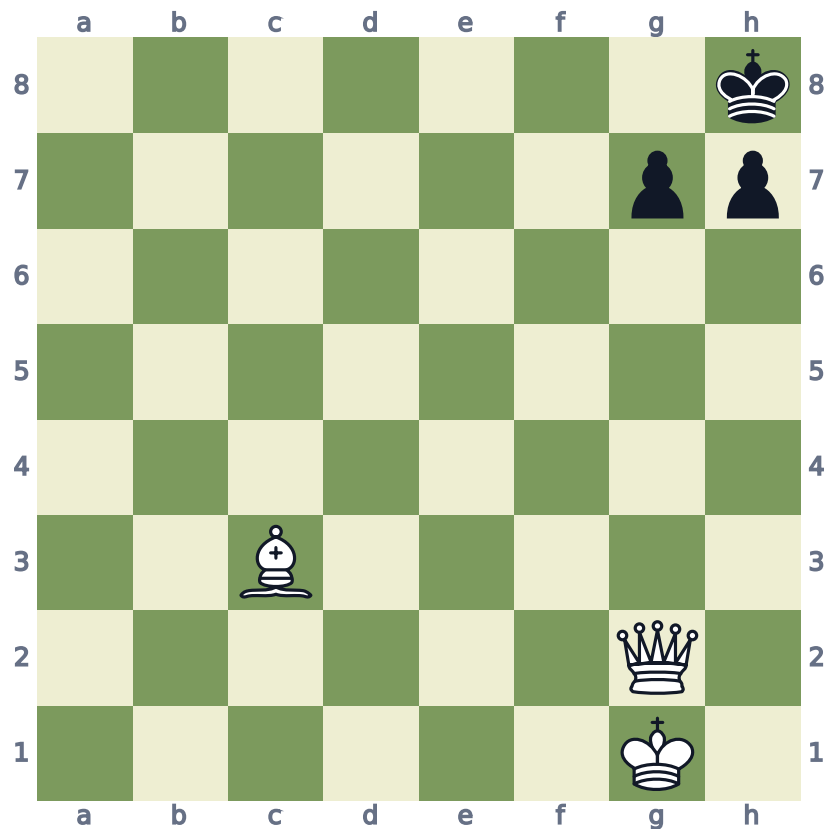
The original attacking picture was Rook-and-bishop back rank. Defensive search should begin by trying to return material. The second engine candidate scores -4.52 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.12.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -4.40 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 17 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-bishop battery



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg8 Qxg7#

WHY IT WORKS

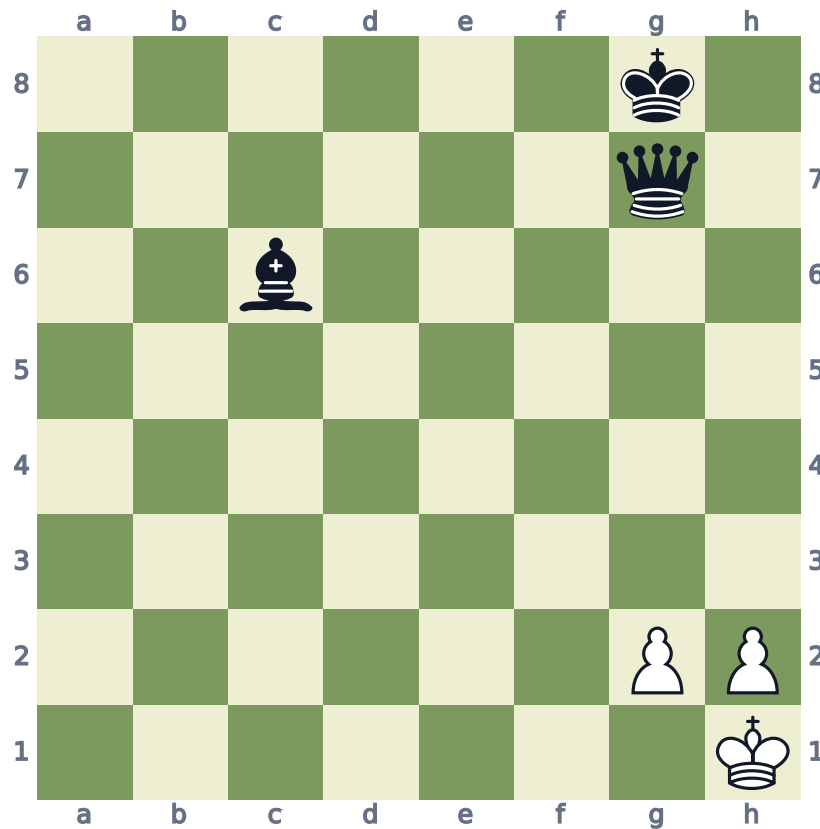
The original attacking picture was Queen-and-bishop battery. Defensive search should begin by trying to block the line. The second engine candidate scores being mated in 1; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: being mated in 1.

SOLUTION 18 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-bishop battery - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. Kg1 Qxg2#

WHY IT WORKS

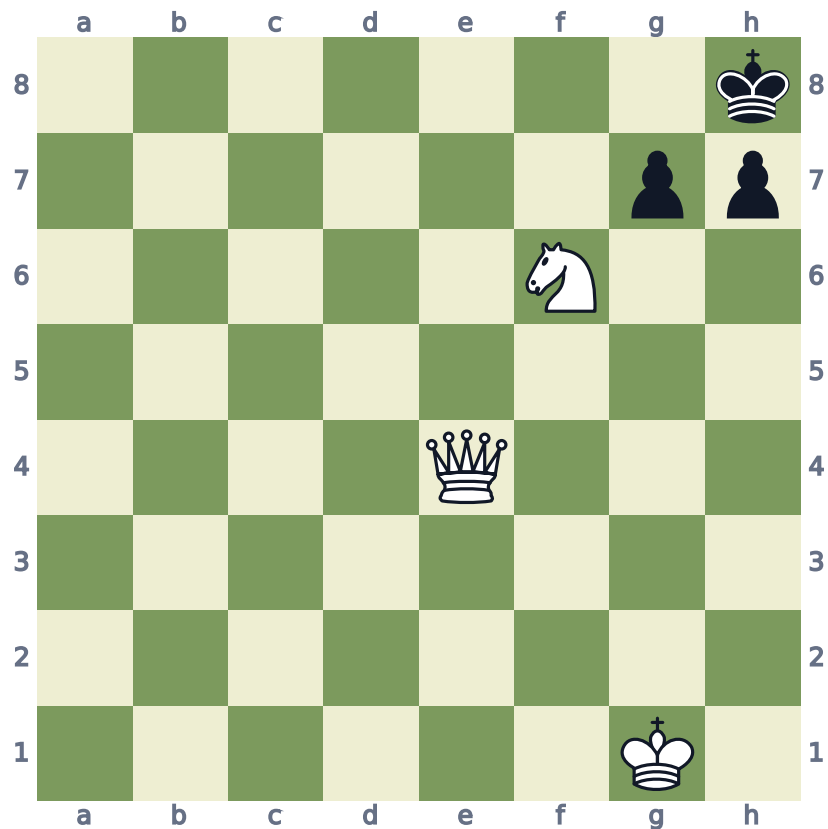
The original attacking picture was Queen-and-bishop battery. Defensive search should begin by trying to remove the key attacker. The second engine candidate scores being mated in 1; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: being mated in 1.

SOLUTION 19 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-knight mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. gxf6 Qe7 2. h6 Qf8+ 3. Kh7 Qxf6 4. Kg8 Qb2 5. Kf8 Kg2

WHY IT WORKS

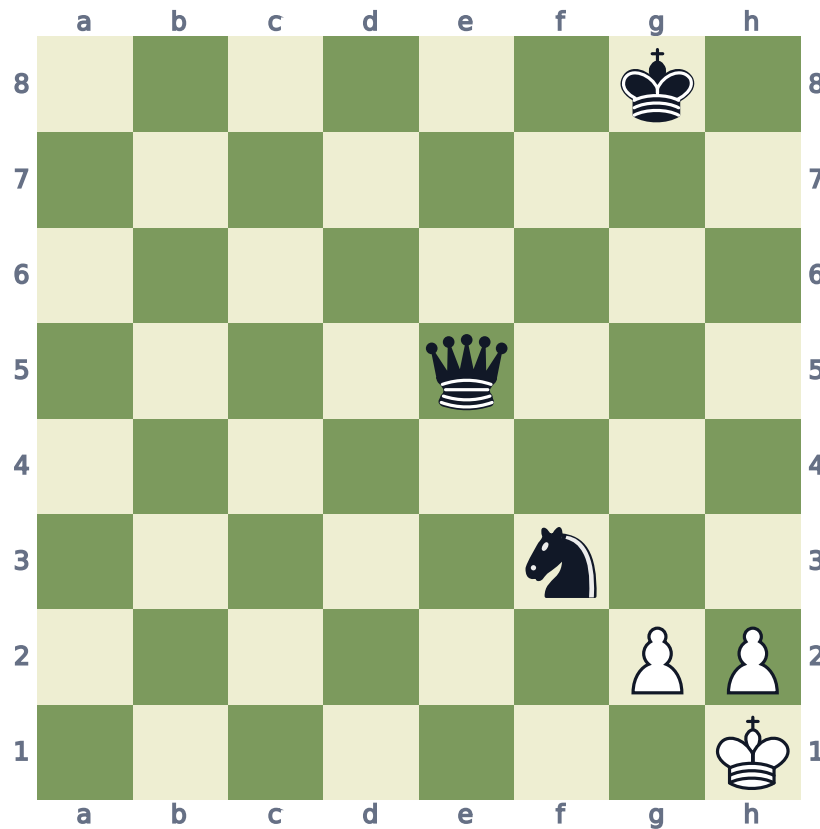
The original attacking picture was Queen-and-knight mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to create flight. The second engine candidate scores being mated in 2; the approximate best-to-second gap is 993.13.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.85 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 20 OF 24

Stop Queen-and-knight mate - reversed colors

**VERIFIED LINE**

1. gxf3 Qe2 2. h3 Qxf3+ 3. Kg1 Qf4 4. Kg2 Qc7 5. Kh1

WHY IT WORKS

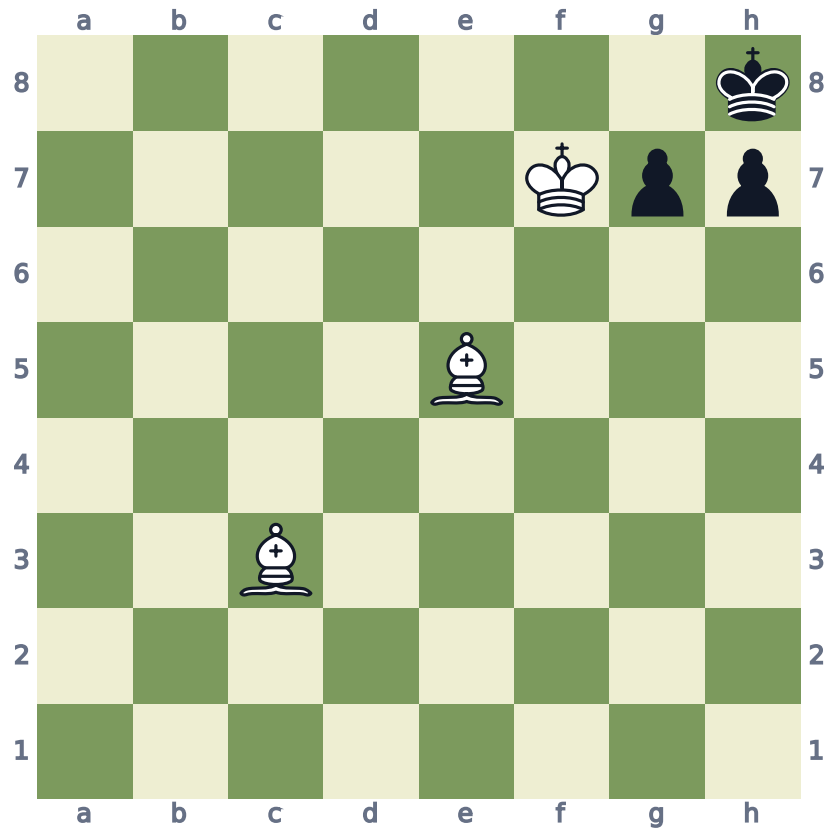
The original attacking picture was Queen-and-knight mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to trade the attacker. The second engine candidate scores being mated in 2; the approximate best-to-second gap is 993.40.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.58 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 21 OF 24

Stop Double-bishop mate



VERIFIED LINE

1. h6 Bxg7+ 2. Kh7 Bf8 3. h5 Be5 4. h4 Bf6 5. h3 Be5

WHY IT WORKS

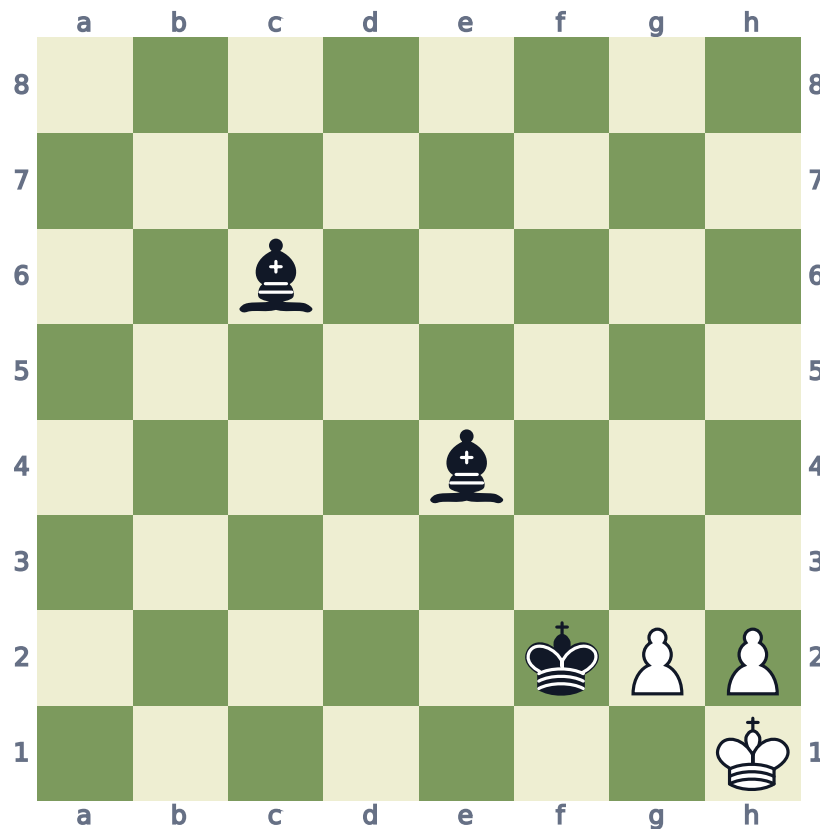
The original attacking picture was Double-bishop mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to countercheck. The second engine candidate scores -6.87 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.41.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -6.46 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 22 OF 24

Stop Double-bishop mate - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. h3 Bxg2+ 2. Kh2 Bf1 3. h4 Bb7 4. h5 Bf3 5. h6 Be4

WHY IT WORKS

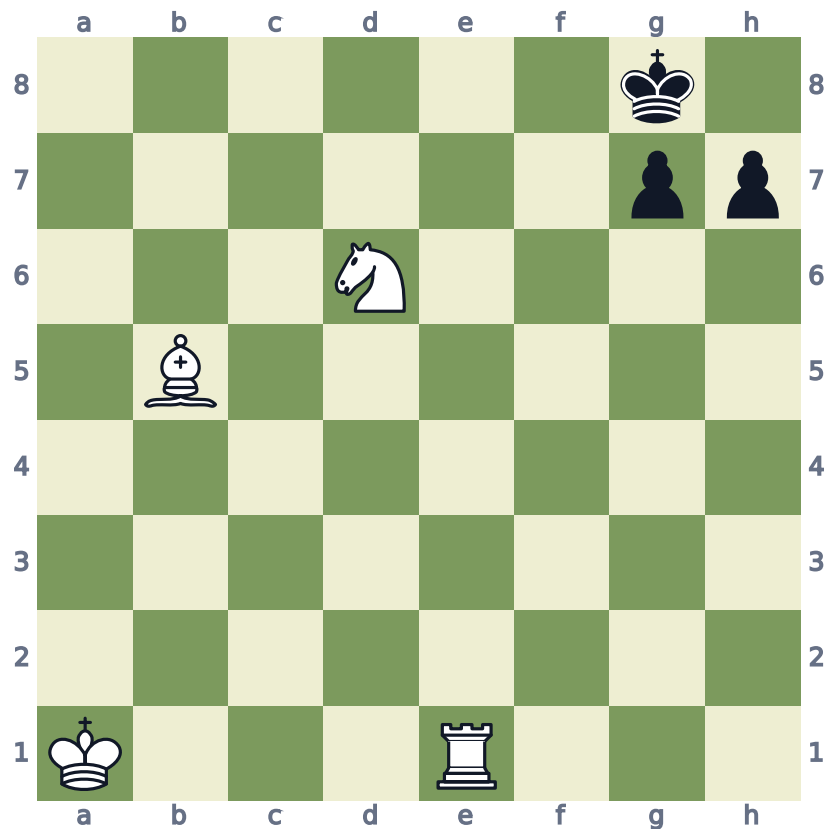
The original attacking picture was Double-bishop mate. Defensive search should begin by trying to return material. The second engine candidate scores -5.68 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -5.68 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 23 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop corridor



VERIFIED LINE

1. g6 Ne8 2. Kf8 Kb1 3. Kf7

WHY IT WORKS

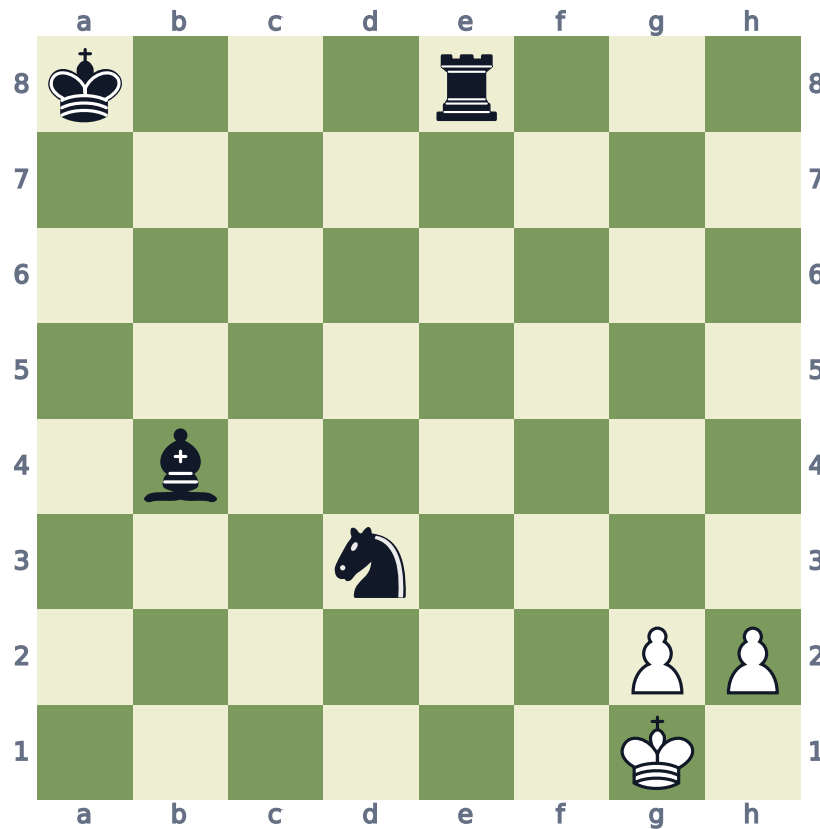
The original attacking picture was Rook-and-bishop corridor. Defensive search should begin by trying to block the line. The second engine candidate scores -5.37 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.00.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -5.37 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 24 OF 24

Stop Rook-and-bishop corridor - reversed colors



VERIFIED LINE

1. g3 Kb7 2. Kg2 Bc3 3. h4 Kb6 4. Kf3

WHY IT WORKS

The original attacking picture was Rook-and-bishop corridor. Defensive search should begin by trying to remove the key attacker. The second engine candidate scores -5.36 from the side-to-move perspective; the approximate best-to-second gap is 0.06.

SCORING

2 best move, 2 main line, 2 best defense, 2 endpoint evaluation = 8 points Engine assessment: -5.30 from the side-to-move perspective.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.